

## Exercises

**45.1** Look at A opposite. Which word combination with 'culture' relates to each of the following?

- 1 The men really dominate in this company – they don't make life easy for women at all. All they talk about is football.
- 2 They say that if you go home at 5.30, you can't be doing your job properly. But I'm going anyway.
- 3 We're all encouraged to go on courses and to keep up our specialist knowledge.
- 4 There was a time when managers could only wear white shirts in this particular company – things are a bit less formal now. (2 expressions)
- 5 In this country, it's easy to do business and there's very little bureaucracy.
- 6 All the chief executives in the company's history have had a background in selling.

**45.2** Read this information about two very different companies and answer the questions.

The Associated Box Company (ABC) and the Superior Box Company (SBC) both make cardboard boxes.

At ABC, there are three different levels of management between the CEO and the people who actually make the boxes. At SBC, there is only one level.

Managers at ABC are very distant. They rarely leave their offices, they have their own executive restaurant and the employees hardly ever see them. Employees are never consulted in decision-making. At SBC, managers share the same canteen with employees. Managers have long meetings with employees before taking important decisions.

Managers and the CEO of SBC have an open-door policy where employees can come to see them about any complaint they might have. At ABC, employees must sort out problems with the manager immediately above them.

At ABC, employees call their managers 'Sir'. At SBC, everyone uses first names.

- 1 Which company is ... ?
  - a more hierarchical
  - b more informal in the way people talk to each other
- 2 In which company are managers ... ?
  - a more approachable
  - b more remote
- 3 In which company are employees ... ?
  - a more deferential
  - b on more equal terms with their bosses

### Over to you

Look again at the issues in 45.2 above. What is the power-distance culture in your country in general? Think of the distance between teachers and students in your school, or between managers and subordinates.

## A

**Individualism**

**Individualism** and **collectivism** relate to the way individuals form and behave in groups. This affects how companies operate.

In **individualist** societies, such as in the United States, the **connections** between individuals and the company are unique. Every employee is viewed as an **independent entity** and has a high level of personal responsibility.

In **collectivist** societies, such as in China, employees are part of strong groups, which protect them in exchange for their **loyalty** – feeling that they will do nothing to harm the group. The relationship between employer and employee or business partners is based on **trust** and **harmony**.

## B

**Time**

Attitudes towards **time** can vary enormously. Look at this information about France.

a **Working hours**

People start work at 8.30 or 9 and officially finish at 6, though many managers start later and stay at work much longer. Among some managers there is a culture of **presenteeism** – being at work when you don't really need to be.

b **Holidays**

Employees take five weeks' **holiday** a year and often take four of them in August. Many companies close down completely that month. There are a lot of **bank holidays** or **public holidays** (about 15) during the year.

Note

BrE: **holiday**  
AmE: **vacation**c **Meals and entertaining**

The **lunch break** is important and a lot of business is done over restaurant lunches. There are no snacks between meals, just coffee. Lunch, more than dinner, is important for discussing business. The **working breakfast** is rare.

d **Punctuality**

If you arrive five minutes after the time given for meetings, nobody minds, or even comments on it. If you are invited to someone's house (which is unusual in business), arrive between 15 to 30 minutes after the time given.

e **Boundaries** – limits – **between work and private life**

Don't **phone** people at home about work, and don't phone them at all after 9 pm.

## C

**Cross-cultural communication**

Here are some more areas for potential cultural misunderstandings.

a **distance** when talking to people – What is comfortable?b **eye contact** – How much of the time do people look directly at each other?c **gesture** – Do people make a lot of facial gestures? How much do they move their arms and hands?d **greetings/goodbyes** – Do people shake hands every time? Are there fixed phrases to say?e **humour** – Is this a good way of relaxing people? Or is it out of place in some contexts?f **physical contact** – How much do people touch each other?g **presents** – When should you give them? When should you open them?  
What should you say when you receive one?

Note

BrE: **humour**  
AmE: **humor**h **rules of conversation** and the **role of silence** – How long can people be silent before they feel uncomfortable? Is it acceptable to interrupt when others are speaking?

## Exercises

**46.1** Complete the sentences using appropriate forms of words and expressions from A opposite.

- 1 Those from ..... cultures are more likely to describe themselves as part of a social group with statements such as “I am a student, from Oxfordshire, part of a private flying club,” whereas people from ..... cultures will present more personal information like characteristics and preferences: “I am shy, I want to be a doctor, I like pizza.”
- 2 He is a man with a strong sense of moral responsibility and a commitment to ..... between individuals and communities.
- 3 It was a difficult decision the business partners had to make, but because they have the ..... of the employees, it was quickly accepted.
- 4 This department must show a high level of group ..... and expect high performance levels to be achieved by each team member.
- 5 Isn't there any middle ground between ..... and the selfless call for ..... ? Why must it be one or the other?
- 6 It's not easy for this team to work together; they all think of themselves as .....

**46.2** Insert each heading (a–e) from B opposite at an appropriate place in this description of Swedish business culture.

- (1) ..... There is high consumption of coffee and snacks during the day. Lunch is not that important. Evenings can be spent with clients in the capital's restaurants, but there is not much night life outside the capital. In other cities, business hotels are good for entertaining.
- (2) ..... It's OK to phone people at home about work-related issues until about 9.30 pm.
- (3) ..... There are not that many public holidays and many people own houses in the country where they relax when they have days off or longer holidays.
- (4) ..... People finish work earlier each day in summer in order to benefit from the long summer evenings – this is part of a culture of work–life balance, which is very important. Even so, some managers don't see much of their families during the week.
- (5) ..... If you are invited to dinner at 8 pm, it's not a problem to arrive at 8 on the dot!

**46.3** Match one of the items of advice (1–8) relating to different cultures with each point (a–h) in C opposite.

- 1 Don't start speaking immediately after the other person finishes – it shows you're considering what they said. ☐
- 2 It's probably best not to tell jokes at all – avoid the danger of your humour not being appreciated! ☐
- 3 When you receive a gift, open it immediately and thank the person at length. ☐
- 4 Don't touch people's heads – adults or children. ☐
- 5 Remember to shake hands each time you say goodbye. ☐
- 6 Stand about a metre and a half away – people feel more comfortable at this distance. ☐
- 7 Feel free to underline your points using your hand and arm, but don't overdo it! ☐
- 8 Look the other person in the eye for about half the time. ☐

### Over to you

Write a description for your own country like the one in B opposite.

# 47

## Telephoning 1: phones and numbers

### A

#### Telephones and beyond

- **landline** – a ‘traditional’ phone plugged into the wall
- public **telephone** / **payphone** – a phone in a public place operated with coins or a **phone card**
- **mobile phone** (BrE) / **cellphone** (AmE) – a phone you can carry with you. Callers can **leave a voice message** on **voicemail**, or send you a written **text message** or **text**.
- **smartphone** – a mobile phone that can be used as a small computer and that connects to the internet
- With **3G** mobile phone networks you can use your smartphone to connect to the internet and with a **4G** signal the internet connection is faster.
- **extension** – one of a number of phones on the same **line**, in a home or office
- **cordless phone** or **cordless** – a phone extension not attached by a wire that you can use when you are walking around the house, outside in the garden, etc.
- **VoIP** (voice over internet protocol) – uses the internet for phone calls, such as on **Skype**, so you don’t pay the normal phone charges
- **webcam and microphone** – a camera attached to a computer so that two people connected over the internet can see each other and talk to each other using the microphone
- **videoconferencing** allows several people in one place to see people in another location and hold a meeting together. This is normally used to refer to companies who have their own systems, but videoconferencing can now also be done with participants each using their individual webcam over the internet.

### B

#### ‘Phone’, ‘call’ and ‘ring’

call  
to phone } someone  
telephone }

to give someone a call

#### Note

In BrE you can say:

to **ring** someone  
to **ring up** someone  
to **ring** someone up

In AmE you can say:

to **call up** someone  
to **call** someone up

In BrE, you can also say:

to **give** someone a ring

In informal BrE, you can also say:

to **give** someone a bell  
a buzz

### C

#### Numbers

When saying numbers, use rising intonation for each group, except for the last group, when you should use a falling tone. This shows you have reached the end of the number.

|                 | country code | area code          | number          |              |
|-----------------|--------------|--------------------|-----------------|--------------|
| 00              | 44           | 1746               | 845             | 921          |
| Double oh (BrE) | double four  | one seven four six | eight four five | nine two one |
| Zero zero (AmE) | four four    |                    |                 |              |

### D

#### Doing things over the phone

Phone numbers for particular purposes include:

- **helpline/information line** – you can find out about a company’s products or services
- **hotline** – often used by companies as a more exciting alternative to ‘helpline’
- **booking/reservations line** – make bookings for events, travel and hotels

#### Note

People who answer and deal with calls like these work in **call centres** (BrE); **call centers** (AmE).  
BrE/AmE: **reservations**; BrE only: **booking**  
A number that you can call free of charge is:  
**an 0800 number** or **a freephone number** (BrE);  
**a 1-800 number** or **a toll-free number** (AmE).



## Exercises

**47.1** Which type of phone or service in A opposite would each of these people use?

- 1 Two people in different countries who want to talk without paying for an international call.
- 2 Five company managers in different countries who want to talk and see each other using a special system set up by their company.
- 3 A building contractor who works in lots of different places.
- 4 Someone who wants to stay in touch when they're in their garden.
- 5 A teenager who has gone out without her mobile and wants to tell her parents where she is. (2 expressions)
- 6 A manager who phones a colleague and finds that their mobile is switched off. (2 expressions)
- 7 Two ordinary people – not company managers – each sitting in their own bedroom in their respective homes, without access to a special system, who use the internet to see and talk to each other.



**47.2** Look at B opposite and decide which of these items are grammatical. Correct the ungrammatical ones.

- 1 It would be good to see Anna soon. I'll phone to her and see when she's free.
- 2 I gave Brian a call yesterday and we had a long chat.
- 3 Why you don't ring to Pizza Palace and order some takeaway pizza?
- 4 I rang them five minutes ago but there was no answer.
- 5 Call up me next time you're in New York.
- 6 Give me a ring when you're next in London.
- 7 I'll give the bell to her and we'll go out for a meal.
- 8 When you get some news, make me a call.

**47.3** Look at C opposite. You phone the Cross-Channel Ferry Company and you hear this:

'Welcome to the Cross-Channel Ferry Company's freephone hotline. If you'd like to receive a brochure, press 1. For today's sailing times and weather conditions, press 2. If you'd like to make a reservation, press 3. If you'd like to change an existing reservation, press 4. If you want to book a package holiday, press 5. If you want to hear this list again, press 6.'

Which number do you press in these situations?

- a You have a reservation on the 15.00 ferry and you want to take the 18.00 instead.
- b You want to book a return trip.
- c You are confused about the different choices.
- d You often get seasick and want to check how rough the sea will be today.
- e You want a ferry crossing and an organized trip to the Loire Chateaux.

### Over to you

- Do you like using call centres, or do you prefer to look for information, make bookings, etc. on the internet?
- When was the last time you called an organization? What happened? Were you happy with the way the call was dealt with?

# 48

## Telephoning 2: trying to get through

### A Asking to speak to someone

Mike Barr wants to speak to Jane Owen.



Primo Plastics, **good morning.**

**Hello. Can you put me through to Jane Owen in Sales, please?**<sup>1</sup>

**One moment, please.**<sup>2</sup> I'm afraid the line's busy. Do you want to hold or would you like to call back later?

**I'll call again later. What's her direct line?**<sup>3</sup>

**Her direct line is 7942 8321.**

**7942 8321. Thanks. Goodbye.**



You can also say:

<sup>1</sup> Extension 123, **please.**

<sup>2</sup> **I'm putting you through.**

<sup>3</sup> **I'll try again later. Could you give me the number for her direct line?**

### B Voicemail 1

Later, Mike Barr calls again, and this time he **gets through** to Jane's **voicemail**. This is her **greeting**:

'You're **through to the voicemail** of Jane Owen. I'm **away** at a conference **until** Monday the 5th, but **I'll be picking up my voicemail on my mobile**. If you leave a message, **I'll get back to you**. For anything urgent, **please call** my PA, Ros Brown, **on extension 8325**.'

'**Please leave a message after the tone.**'

After leaving a message, you may hear this:

'**To listen to your message**, press 1.'

After listening to your message, you will probably hear this:

'**If you'd like to change your message**, press 2. **If you'd like to delete your message**, press 4. Otherwise, **please hang up**.'

### C Voicemail 2

Mike leaves this message:

'Hello, **this is** Mike Barr **from** Smartauto. **It's about** our order for specialized plastic components. There have been some last-minute changes in the specifications. I hope your manufacturing people haven't started making them yet! **Would it be possible to** call me back **at** my office **on** 0117 893 4522? Otherwise, you could call me **on my mobile** on 07974 522 742 during the weekend, or **first thing** on Monday. **It's very urgent. Bye for now.**'

## Exercises

- 48.1** Arabella Ford is trying to phone John Quinn in Primo's finance department. Complete the gaps with expressions from A opposite. Be careful to use the alternative expressions where necessary.

Receptionist: Primo Plastics, good morning.

Arabella: Hello. Can (1) ..... to John Quinn in Finance, please?

Receptionist: (2) ....., please. I'm (3) .....  
 ..... I'm afraid (4) .....  
 ..... Do you (5) .....  
 ..... or would you like to (6) .....  
 ?

Arabella: I'll (7) ....., .....

(One minute later.)

Receptionist: The line's still (8) ....., I'm afraid.

Arabella: I'll try (9) ..... Could you give me (10) ..... his direct line?

Receptionist: His (11) ..... is 7942 ...

Arabella: 7942 ...

Receptionist: ... 8339.

Arabella: 8339. Thanks. Goodbye.

Receptionist: Goodbye.

- 48.2** Write voicemail greetings for other Primo employees, based on this information, using expressions from B opposite.

- 1 Steve Fox – on holiday until Mon 12th – will not be picking up messages – will respond when he gets back – anything urgent, contact colleague Rob Timmins – extension 8359. If you have message – leave it after tone.
- 2 Sue Leighton – away on business trip until Thursday – will pick up messages – leave a message after the tone – get back to you as soon as possible.
- 3 Rod Baxter – on training course until 20 Jan. Not picking up voicemail – can leave message and will respond when he gets back. Urgent queries – PA Jill Salford – direct line 8466.
- 4 Tina Preston – in meetings all day today, Friday. Leave a message – will get back Monday morning. Urgent matters – colleague Keith Samson – extension 8521.

- 48.3** Another caller leaves a message on Jane Owen's voicemail. Complete the message using the correct words from C opposite.

'Hello, this (1) ..... Jenny Robin (2) ..... Quirky Furniture Ltd. It's very urgent. Would it be possible (3) ..... call me back (4) ..... my office (5) ..... 020 8945 8333 first thing on Tuesday? Otherwise, you could call me this afternoon (6) ..... my mobile (7) ..... 07962 290 821. It's about our order for plastic furniture components. We still haven't received them! Bye for now.'

### Over to you

- What are some of the difficulties in using the phone in English?
- Write a voicemail greeting in English for yourself of a kind you use when not at your office.
- Do you leave messages on people's voicemail? Or do you prefer email?

# 49

## Telephoning 3: getting through

### A

#### Getting through

Mike phones again and gets through to Jane Owen's PA – her personal assistant.

PA: Jane Owen's **office, good morning.**

MB: **Hello. Can I speak to** Jane Owen, **please? Is she available?**

PA: **I'm afraid** Ms Owen's **not available** – she's with a customer **right now.**

MB: **Oh, right. Can I leave a message for her, please?**

PA: **Who's calling, please?**

MB: **It's** Mike Barr **here, from** Smartauto Cars.



### B

#### Giving and taking messages

The personal assistant can also say:

- Can/May I take a message?
- Would you like to leave a message?
- I wonder if you could call back later?
- Can I ask who's calling?
- Could you give me your name?
- Which company are you calling from?
- Can/May I ask what it's about?
- I'll ask her to call you (when she gets back / when she's free).
- I'll give her your message.

The caller could say:

- Could I leave a message?
  - Could you tell her that ... ?
  - I'm calling about ...
  - I want / I'd like to talk about ...
  - I'm calling to confirm that ...
  - Could you ask her to call me back?
- My number's ...

Note

When you answer the phone, you do not say 'I am X.'

### C

#### Spelling names

If you want to spell a name, you can say, for example, 'A for Alpha, B for Bravo', etc.

|        |         |         |        |        |         |          |
|--------|---------|---------|--------|--------|---------|----------|
| Alpha  | Bravo   | Charlie | Delta  | Echo   | Foxtrot | Golf     |
| Hotel  | India   | Juliet  | Kilo   | Lima   | Mike    | November |
| Oscar  | Papa    | Quebec  | Romeo  | Sierra | Tango   | Uniform  |
| Victor | Whiskey | X-ray   | Yankee | Zulu   |         |          |

You may also need these expressions:

|           |         |              |                                          |                        |
|-----------|---------|--------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| capital A | small a | all one word | new word/line                            | dash (–) or hyphen (–) |
| slash (/) | dot (.) | at @         | colon (:) com (as in internet addresses) |                        |

Spell email addresses like this: jane-smith@aol.com = jane hyphen smith at a–o–l dot com.

### D

#### Taking messages: checking information

- a **I'm sorry, I didn't catch** your name. Could you spell it, please?
- b **Is that with** a D **at the end** – D for David?
- c **Did you say** your number is 624 426?
- d **Is that with** B for Bravo **or** V for Victor?
- e **Where did you say** you're calling from?
- f **Is that with** one M **in the middle** or two?
- g The code for Sweden is 49, **right?**
- h **Is that** Milan **like** the city?



## Exercises

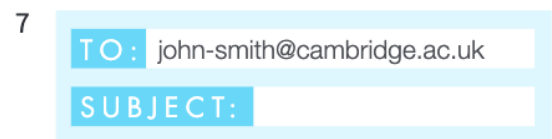
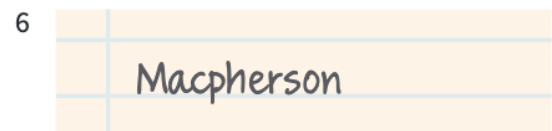
**49.1** Look at A and B opposite. Change the underlined expressions in these conversations so that they are correct and more polite.

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>1 A: <u>I want</u> to speak to Ms Sangster.<br/>         B: <u>She's busy</u>.<br/>         A: <u>I'm</u> Sven Nyman <u>talking</u>.<br/>         B: <u>Why are you calling?</u><br/>         A: <u>I want to discuss</u> her order.<br/>         B: I'll <u>tell</u> her to call you when she's free.</p> | <p>2 A: Hello. Is Jack Bronson <u>able to speak on the phone?</u><br/>         B: <u>No. Who are you? What company do you work for?</u><br/>         A: <u>Rosario Gonzalez. Excelsior Media Services. Take a message for him. Tell him that I've received his cheque.</u><br/>         B: <u>He will get the message.</u></p> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**49.2** Spell the following as you would spell them on the phone. Use the table in C opposite to help you. The first one has been done as an example.

1 Maeght: M for Mike, A for Alpha, E for Echo, G for Golf, H for Hotel, T for Tango.

2 ●Valladolid



**49.3** Match the responses (1–8) with the questions (a–h) in D opposite.

- |                                                            |                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1 No, actually it's 46.                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2 It's Valladolid with a V at the beginning, V for Victor. | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3 No, it's Schmidt with a T at the end, T for Tango.       | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4 Two. T-I-double M-E-R-M-A-N.                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5 No, 642 246.                                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 6 Springer Verlag in Hamburg.                              | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 7 Krieslovski. K-R-I-E-S-L-O-V-S-K-I.                      | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 8 No, it's with two Ls in the middle and a D at the end.   | <input type="checkbox"/> |

### Over to you

- Practise spelling words you have to give on the phone using the alphabet in C opposite.
- Practise giving your own email address and the address of your company's website.

# 50

## Telephoning 4: arrangements and ending calls

### A

#### Phoning again

Mike phones again and gets through to Jane Owen.

MB: **Hello. Can I speak to Jane Owen, please?**

JO: **Speaking.**

MB: **It's Mike Barr here. I tried to phone you last week. It's about our order.**

JO: **Right. I got your message. I was about to call you.**

MB: **Yes, we need to talk more about the technical specifications for the plastic.**



### B

#### Making arrangements

You get through to the person you want to speak to and fix a meeting.

- Can we fix a meeting?  
Shall we arrange an appointment?  
Would it be useful to meet up soon?
- I'll (just) get/check my diary.
- How about tomorrow?  
What about Tuesday?  
Would Wednesday be suitable?  
Would Thursday suit you?  
Shall we say Friday?
- That's fine.
- I can't / won't be able to make Thursday.

### C

#### Closing the conversation

Here are some ways of finishing a conversation without sounding rude.

- See you on Friday then.
- Yes, I'll look forward to seeing you then.
- I'm going to have to go now.  
I've got to go to a meeting.  
I have to go and see someone.
- Nice talking to you.  
(It's been) good talking to you.  
Good to talk to you.
- Nice talking to you.
- Talk to you soon, no doubt.  
Thanks for phoning.  
We'll be (back) in touch soon.  
Look forward to hearing from you soon.
- Thanks for calling.

### D

#### Changing arrangements

Jane Owen and Mike Barr are continuing their conversation.

- a JO: I **can't make** Tuesday. **Something has come up. I've got to** go over to Berlin to see a client. **How about** Wednesday morning?
- b MB: I can't make Wednesday morning, I'm afraid. **Can you make** the afternoon instead?
- c JO: I **think that's OK.** Just let me check my diary ... I'm afraid that's **not going to be possible.** I'd completely forgotten we have a departmental meeting that day. Can we **put it off** till the 22nd?
- d MB: I'm afraid the 22nd **won't be possible.** I'm going to be very busy that day. Could we **put it back** until the following week?
- e JO: I'm **completely snowed under** the following week. **Can we leave it open? I'll get back in touch** when I'm less busy.
- MB: Yes, but we need to make a decision soon!

## Exercises

**50.1** Annelise Schmidt (AS) phones James Cassidy (JC) and arranges to meet him. Reorder their conversation, which contains expressions from A and B opposite.

- a AS: Fine thanks. I'm going to be in London on Tuesday and Wednesday next week. How about meeting up to discuss how Penguin and Sprenger might work together?
- b AS: Hello. This is Annelise Schmidt. You remember we met at the Frankfurt Book Fair last month?
- c AS: Look forward to seeing you then. Bye.
- d AS: Sounds good. Shall I meet you at your office? I've got the address.
- e AS: Yes, that's fine.
- f JC: James Cassidy speaking.
- g JC: Goodbye.
- h JC: I'll just check my diary. I won't be able to make Tuesday. I've got to go to Manchester. Would Wednesday suit you? How about lunch?
- i JC: OK. See you on Wednesday at 12.30, then.
- j JC: Yes, how are you?
- k JC: Yes. Why don't you come round here at about 12.30? Ask for me at reception and I'll come down.

**50.2** Look at B and C opposite. Which of these exchanges are natural, and which are illogical?

- 1 A: Nice talking to you. See you on Wednesday.  
B: See you Wednesday. Thanks for calling. Bye.
- 2 A: I'll look forward to seeing you tomorrow, then.  
B: Talk to you soon, no doubt. Bye.
- 3 A: It's been good talking to you. I'm going to have to go. I've got to go to a meeting.  
B: Nice talking to you. I'll be in touch soon.
- 4 A: See you this afternoon at 4, then.  
B: Yes, we'll be back in touch soon.
- 5 A: I've got to get on with some work. I'm going to have to go.  
B: Talk to you soon, no doubt. Bye.

**50.3** Match these possible replies (1–5) with what the speakers say in D opposite.

- 1 I suppose so: it would have been good to meet. Look forward to hearing from you when you're less busy.
- 2 The 22nd ... I'm going to be on holiday. What about the 29th?
- 3 The afternoon would be no problem. How about at 3?
- 4 Wednesday's going to be difficult. Can you make the next day?
- 5 Yes, the same day the following week would be fine.

|                          |
|--------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> |

### Over to you

- Do you make arrangements on the phone at work – or do you prefer to use email?
- Do you find it difficult to end phone calls in English and also in your own language?

## A

## Business cards 1

**Business cards** are an important source of information about your **business contacts** – people you meet doing business. Business cards may help you understand the **hierarchy** (see Unit 45) of the company you are dealing with. In some places, especially in Asia, it's important to **follow the etiquette** – rules – for their use. In Asia, when someone hands over their card, take it with both hands, look at it carefully and treat it with care and respect. Do not write or make notes on it. Store it carefully. Hand over your card in return, ensuring that you always have a supply with you.

## B

## Business cards 2



\*Chartered Institute of Marketing

<sup>1</sup>**first name**

<sup>2</sup>**middle initial** – some people use an initial to show the first letter of their middle name

<sup>3</sup>**family name, surname** – in the Western world, the family name comes last (in China and some other places it comes first)

<sup>4</sup>**job title** – the official name of someone's job

<sup>5</sup>**qualifications** – some people show their **academic qualifications**

<sup>6</sup>**membership of professional organizations**

<sup>7</sup>**contact details** – phone numbers, email address, postal address, etc.

## C

## Staying in touch

Gunilla Madsen is speaking to Wu Lee.

GM: Thanks for your card. Wu is your family name, right?

WL: Yes, but please call me Lee.

GM: OK. Yes, I think you'll be very interested in our latest equipment – the technical specifications have only just been finalized.

WL: **Could you email** the specs to me when you get back, Gunilla? My **email address** is on my card.

GM: Sure. I'll **attach** the specs to the email. It's going to be quite a **large attachment**! There are about ten pages of specs. And I'll send some brochures **by courier** – we use DHL.

WL: No problem.

GM: **Please get back to me** if you have any questions, of course. Email is probably easiest.

WL: Especially with the time difference between Shanghai and Oslo!

GM: Yes, but **don't hesitate to give me a call** if you'd like to discuss anything. People don't use the phone enough these days!

WL: No, they don't. So, **we'll be in touch** soon ... **by email** or **by phone**.

GM: Absolutely, it was very nice meeting you, Lee.

WL: Likewise!



## Exercises

- 51.1** George was representing his company, Primo Plastics, on their stand at a trade fair in Tokyo. Look at A opposite and identify five mistakes that he made in relation to card etiquette.

A Japanese businessman, Bunzo Watanabe, came to the stand and said that Primo Plastics was the sort of special plastics company that his company might like to work with. He handed over his card, and George took it with one hand. He wrote 'Tokyo trade fair' on the back to remind him where he had met Mr Watanabe. He did not read the card carefully, but put it casually in his pocket. When Mr Watanabe asked for George's card, George said, 'Sorry, but I've run out. I'll write my details on a sheet of paper.'

- 51.2** Look at B opposite. Then identify the items below (1–7) on each card. Write the numbers next to the items.



\*Institute of Purchasing Managers

- |                         |                                            |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1 first name            | 5 qualifications                           |
| 2 middle initial        | 6 membership of professional organizations |
| 3 family name / surname | 7 contact details, including email address |
| 4 job title             |                                            |

- 51.3** Complete the conversation between the people in 51.2 using expressions from C opposite.

WS: OK. Yes, I think you'll be very interested in the latest technical developments – we can offer consultancy services that will help you choose the right textile supplier.

FR: Could you email me something when you get back, Wolfgang? My **(1)** .....  
 ..... is on my card.

WS: Of course, but it's going to be quite a large **(2)** ..... ! Our electronic 'brochure' is about 15 pages long.

FR: No problem.

WS: Please don't hesitate to **(3)** ..... if you have any questions, of course. Email is probably easiest ...

FR: Even if there's no time difference between Frankfurt and Milan!

WS: Yes, please feel free **(4)** .....  
 ..... It's sometimes easier to talk over the phone rather than by email.

FR: Yes, you're right.

WS: And I can always send textile samples **(5)** ..... : we use FedEx.

FR: Good. In our business it's always good to be able to see and touch the fabric.

WS: Absolutely. Well, it was very nice meeting you, Francesca.

FR: Likewise! We'll be in touch soon, no doubt.

### Over to you

You meet someone at a conference and promise to send them more information about your school or organization. Write an email to them.

## A

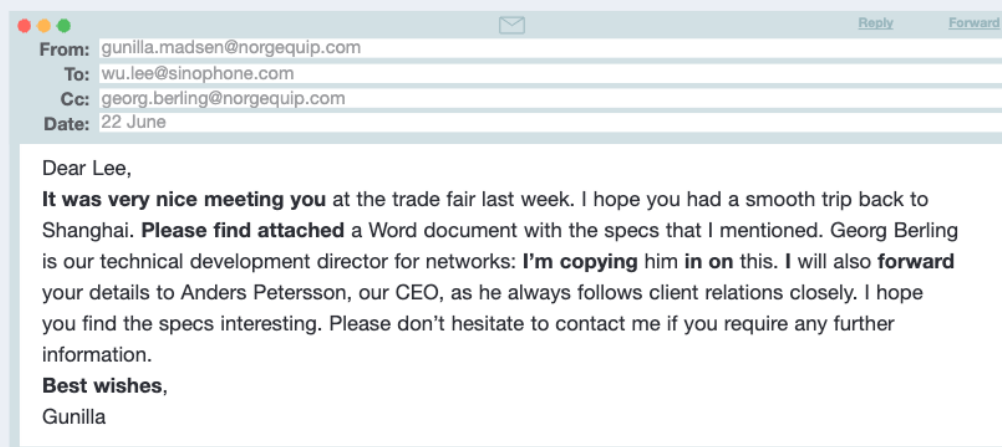
## Email

Most email programs on computers have **icons** with abbreviations like these:

- **inbox** contains email waiting for you to read
- **subject** – what the email is about
- **cc** – copy this email to ...
- **bcc** – blind copy this email to ... (so that the other people you're sending the email to don't know you're sending this copy)
- **fwd** allows you to **forward** an email – to send an email you have received to someone else
- **delete** allows you to get rid of an email you don't want to keep
- **reply** allows you to send an answer back to the person who sent the email
- **reply to all** allows you to send the answer to the person who sent the email, plus all those who received copies of it
- **attach** allows you to send an **attachment** – a document that you **attach to** and send with an email
- **contact information** can be inserted automatically at the end of an email with your **contact details** – name, phone number, etc.
- the **address book** allows you to store the **email addresses** of people that you write to

## B

## Email expressions



## C

## Beginnings and endings

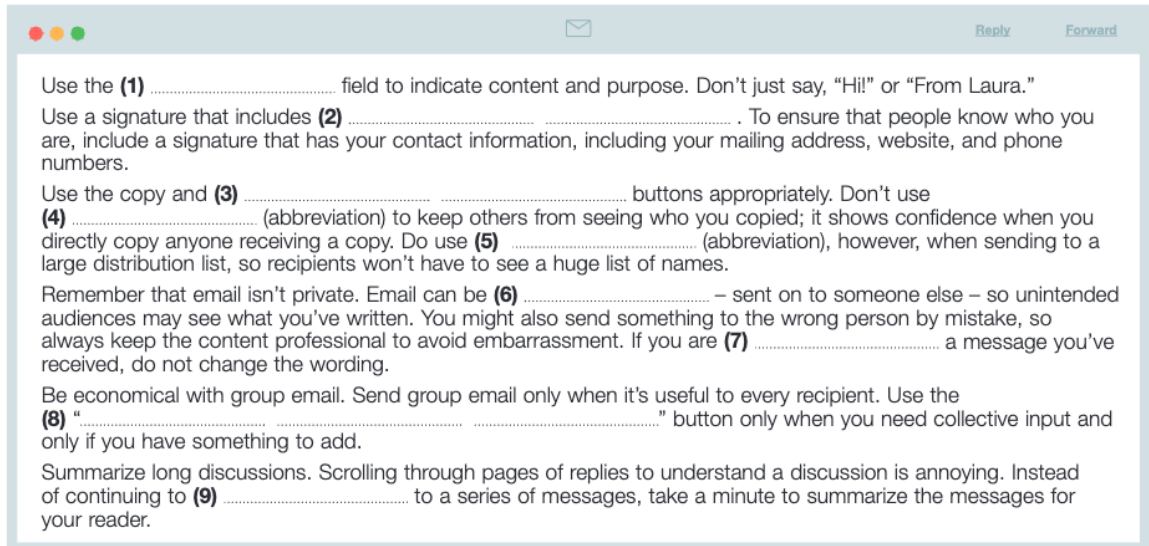
It's important to use the right degree of **formality** – seriousness – and **deference** (see Unit 45).

The following beginnings range from formal to informal: **Dear Sir/Madam** (used when you don't know the person's name), **Dear Ms** Caxton, **Dear Zoe** and **Hi Zoe**.

The following endings range from formal to informal and are used mainly in emails and faxes: **Best regards**, **Regards**, **Best wishes**, **All the best**, **Best. Yours faithfully** (BrE only) is used in letters and faxes when you don't know the person's name, **Yours sincerely** (AmE **Sincerely**) is less formal and **Yours** is the least formal ending.

## Exercises

- 52.1** Complete these tips on using email with appropriate forms of expressions from A opposite. (Some items are abbreviations and other items are full forms. You can use some items more than once.)



Use the (1) ..... field to indicate content and purpose. Don't just say, "Hi!" or "From Laura."

Use a signature that includes (2) ..... . To ensure that people know who you are, include a signature that has your contact information, including your mailing address, website, and phone numbers.

Use the copy and (3) ..... buttons appropriately. Don't use (4) ..... (abbreviation) to keep others from seeing who you copied; it shows confidence when you directly copy anyone receiving a copy. Do use (5) ..... (abbreviation), however, when sending to a large distribution list, so recipients won't have to see a huge list of names.

Remember that email isn't private. Email can be (6) ..... – sent on to someone else – so unintended audiences may see what you've written. You might also send something to the wrong person by mistake, so always keep the content professional to avoid embarrassment. If you are (7) ..... a message you've received, do not change the wording.

Be economical with group email. Send group email only when it's useful to every recipient. Use the (8) "....." button only when you need collective input and only if you have something to add.

Summarize long discussions. Scrolling through pages of replies to understand a discussion is annoying. Instead of continuing to (9) ..... to a series of messages, take a minute to summarize the messages for your reader.

- 52.2** You are Wu Lee. Reply to the email in B opposite, using the same expressions.

- Open suitably.
- Say it was good to meet Gunilla too.
- You are attaching some information about your company, Sinophone.
- You are informing your colleague Lin Weng, purchasing manager, about the meeting by sending him a copy of the email at the same time.
- You will send Gunilla's details to another colleague in another email, Shu Bao: finance director.
- End suitably.

- 52.3** Which expressions from C opposite would you use to begin and end each of these emails?

- 1 You are writing as informally as possible to a friend (Jim) you know very well.
- 2 You are writing to a company where you would like to work, but you don't know the name of the person who will read your email.
- 3 You are writing to a woman whose family name you know (Preston) but not her first name; you want to end relatively formally.
- 4 You are writing to someone you know vaguely (Mike); you want to end with an average level of formality.
- 5 You are writing to a man (Brian Collins) in your organization who is much more senior than you, and whom you have never met.
- 6 You are writing to a woman whose name you don't know; end suitably.

### Over to you

- Does email save time – or does it just make more work?
- Should company employees be allowed to send and receive personal emails at work, and surf the internet?

## A

## CV tips

A **CV** or **curriculum vitae** is a document about your education, career and objectives. Look at the tips:

- a Put your **name** and **contact details** at the top.
- b Talk about your **career goal** – professional objective.
- c Mention your **skills** (see Unit 4).
- d Include your **qualifications** (see Unit 4).
- e Write about your **experience** and your **achievements**.
- f You can mention relevant **interests**.
- g Use **keywords** relevant to the employer, ones that will be picked out by automated systems.
- h Avoid **exaggerations** – saying something is better or more important than it really is.
- i Be **concise** – not more than two pages, preferably one.

## Note

BrE: **CV** or **curriculum vitae**  
AmE: **résumé** or **resume**.  
**Experience** is uncountable in this context: 'I have a lot of experience in this area', not **experiences**.

## B

## Parts of a CV

**Layout** is the way that information is arranged on the page. Clear layout is very important for CVs.

## MARIA SOARES

34 Avenida da Liberdade, 1250 Lisbon, Portugal

email: maria.soares88@gmail.com

mobile: +351 93 472 3792

**Career goal:** Looking for a **stimulating**<sup>1</sup> career in web design in an **established**<sup>2</sup> design company

**Skills:**

Visual **creativity**<sup>3</sup>; good **leadership skills**<sup>4</sup>; Understanding of all technical and design issues in website construction and maintenance; **Bilingual**<sup>5</sup> in Portuguese and English

**Qualifications:**

2016–2017 London Business School – MBA

2011–2012 University of Berlin – Master's degree in Advanced Web Design (course taught in English)

2002–2007 Porto School of Architecture and Design – Architecture degree

**Experience:**

2012–2016 **Freelance**<sup>6</sup> Web Designer, based in Berlin. Worked with a number of German internationals, contributing design and technical expertise.

2009–2011 Internet Advertising Manager, Publicidades Inovativas, Lisbon. Worked on key client website advertising campaigns.

2007–2009 Architectural Assistant, Projetos do Norte, Porto. Provided support to senior members of the firm, working on commercial building projects.

- <sup>1</sup> interesting and exciting
- <sup>2</sup> one that has existed for some time
- <sup>3</sup> producing new ideas
- <sup>4</sup> ability to manage people and lead them in new directions
- <sup>5</sup> able to speak two languages
- <sup>6</sup> working independently, not as a company employee

## C

## Cover letters and emails

Find out if you should send your application by post or email. If by email, you can copy your **cover letter** into the email, or send it as an attachment. Look at Maria's **cover email**.

To: recruitment@lisbonwebdesign.pt

Subject: Application for **position** of Department Manager

Dear Ms Santos

**I am writing with reference** to your online advertisement for a department manager. **As you will see** from the **attached CV**, my background is in this area. I have long experience of web design, and I recently completed an MBA in London, where I developed my management and leadership skills.

**I would now like to relocate** back to Portugal.

**I am available** for interview on the date that you mention.

**I look forward to hearing from you.**

Best regards

Maria Soares

## Note

**Position** is a formal word for 'job', used especially in the context of job applications.

If writing a letter, start **Dear Sir or Madam**, or **Dear** ....., with the name of the person if you know it, and end **Yours sincerely**. Cover emails and letters should also be concise – less than one page.



## Exercises

**53.1** A recruiter is making comments about various candidates' CVs. Which point in A opposite does each comment refer to?

- 1 She's certainly not short and to the point – it's four pages long!
- 2 He speaks Japanese and Chinese, having lived in each country for 10 years.
- 3 She hopes to get into senior management one day.
- 4 He says he has a degree, but we checked with his university – he dropped out and didn't finish the course.
- 5 She puts her address, mobile number and email address at the top – that's good.
- 6 He has a degree in marketing and is a member of the Chartered Institute of Marketing – he passed all the exams.
- 7 She plays hockey, so she must be a good team player.
- 8 He mentions all the right words – that's why the computer picked out his CV.
- 9 She talks about her 15-year career with Google and the number of people she managed there.

**53.2** Complete this CV with headings from A and B opposite.

### Alexandre Duchamp

(1) .....  
 1999–2002 Mechanical engineering degree, University of Toronto  
 2002–2003 Master's in electric car engineering, University of Vancouver

(2) .....  
 To work in the most advanced areas of electric car design and engineering

(3) .....  
 Good at working independently  
 Bilingual in French and English

(4) .....  
 2003–2009 Production engineer at General Motors, Peoria, Illinois  
 2009–2017 Development engineer, driverless cars, at Tesla Design Center, Hawthorne, California

(5) .....  
 14350 Manor Drive, Hawthorne, CA 90250  
 Email: aduchamp1980@hotmail.com Tel: +1 424 825 3910

**53.3** Complete this cover email by choosing the correct expressions from C opposite.

To: jobs@canadelec.com  
 From: aduchamp1980@hotmail.com  
 Subject: Application for position of driverless car engineer

Dear Mr Wright

(1) ..... from the (2) ..... , my background is in electric car engineering, and (3) ..... to your online advertisement for driverless car engineers. I have been working in the US for nearly 15 years and (4) ..... back to Canada.

(5) ..... (6) ..... for interview on the date that you mention in the advertisement.

Best wishes  
 Alexandre Duchamp

### Over to you

Write your own CV. If you already have one, look at it again and use the ideas and vocabulary in this unit to update it.

## A

## Interns

'Hi, I'm Phoebe. Ten years ago I was doing an economics degree at university and I wanted a career in **financial services** (see Unit 13). I checked online for **paid internships** and I found one at Hearst Banking Group (HBG) which I did while I was still studying. They said we would:

- receive **training** and information on all the careers available in financial services
- gain actual, **hands-on experience** in a real **work environment**
- develop **professional skills** such as leadership and communication
- work with and **learn from** other people with a wide range of knowledge and experience
- **develop** our **network** of contacts
- **build** our **confidence**



'It was all true: I did an internship while I was still a student, and what's more, I got paid! With my experience as an **intern** and just after I **graduated** from university, I was offered a place on HBG's **graduate leadership programme**. And now, 10 years later, I manage some of HBG's most profitable **financial products** (see Unit 35).'

Note

Organizations also talk about offering **work placements** or **job placements**, instead of 'internships'.

## B

## Experience or exploitation?

However, some interns say that the tasks they are given to do are very **menial** – ordinary and boring, like renaming computer files. Another criticism is that there is such a **range of tasks** that interns don't gain particular knowledge of any of them. They may complain that they are **exploited** – some are on very low pay or completely **unpaid**.

Note

The noun related to **exploit** is **exploitation**.

## C

## Trainees and apprentices

**Trainees** are employees in **entry-level jobs** – the lowest level jobs in an organization. Some companies offer a number of **traineeships** every year. Some governments pay part of the costs of employing trainees and you can apply if you have little or no work experience.

**Apprenticeships** combine practical training for a job with **part-time study**. **Apprentices** work with experienced employees, gain **job-specific skills**, and study towards a **vocational qualification** at the same time, perhaps one day a week. Apprentices often train to work in manufacturing, construction – building work – or catering – working in restaurants.



Note

Interns may or may not get permanent jobs in the organization, but trainees and apprentices are usually employed long-term.

## Exercises

- 54.1** Complete this conversation about an internship in an advertising agency with appropriate forms of words from A and B.

Where and when did you do your internship?

It was in an advertising agency, just after I **(1)** ..... university.

Were you paid?

They said that we would get €300 a month, but it turned out to be completely **(2)** .....

What sort of tasks did they ask you to do?

I wanted to gain actual **(3)** ..... - ....., but they just asked me to do totally **(4)** ..... things like making coffee. And there was such a **(5)** ..... that we didn't get to learn any of them properly.

Were you able to develop in any way?

No, they promised we would develop our **(6)** ....., like meeting skills, but this never happened. They said that we would feel more sure of ourselves, that we would **(7)** ....., but at the end I felt less sure of myself! And they said we would **(8)** ..... other people, but we never met anyone from whom to learn.

What about making new contacts?

As I say, we didn't meet anyone, except other interns, so there was no chance to **(9)** .....

So, it wasn't a positive experience?

No, the agency just **(10)** ..... us, basically.

- 54.2** Which words and expressions in C opposite do these examples refer to?

- 1 Schemes to help new technicians in a television company to gain the required skills, and the people who are helped in this way. (2 words)
- 2 People getting coffee for technicians working on a film.
- 3 Going to classes two evenings a week to learn the maths you need in a particular job.
- 4 Schemes to help manual workers in a metal products firm gain the required skills for operating machines by learning from other employees, and the people who are helped in this way. (2 words)
- 5 The studies that someone has followed and the skills they have acquired to be a hairdresser, as proved by a certificate.
- 6 The knowledge and abilities needed in order to be an airline pilot.



### Over to you

Look on the internet for information about internships in an organization that interests you. What kind of experience would you get? Is there anything you don't like about it? Is it paid or unpaid?

## A

## Word combinations with 'meeting'

|               |           |                                                |
|---------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------|
| arrange       | a meeting | organize a meeting                             |
| set up        |           |                                                |
| fix           |           |                                                |
| bring forward |           | make a meeting earlier than originally decided |
| put back      |           |                                                |
| put off       |           | make a meeting later than originally planned   |
| postpone      |           |                                                |
| call off      |           | decide not to have a meeting                   |
| cancel        |           |                                                |
| run chair     |           | be in charge of a meeting                      |
| attend        |           | go to a meeting                                |
| miss          |           | not go to a meeting                            |

## Note

You can say 'bring forward a meeting' or 'bring a meeting forward'. But you can only say 'bring it forward', not 'bring forward it'. The rule is the same for **put back** and **call off**.

## B

## Types of meeting

- **chat** – informal discussion – with colleagues at the coffee machine
- **brainstorming** among colleagues where as many ideas are produced as possible, but are then evaluated later
- **project meeting / team meeting** of employees involved in a particular activity
- **department meeting / departmental meeting**
- **meeting with suppliers** – for example, to negotiate prices for an order
- **meeting with a customer** – for example, to discuss a contract
- **board meeting** – an official, formal meeting of a company's directors
- **AGM: annual general meeting** (BrE) / **annual meeting** (AmE) – where shareholders discuss the company's annual report
- **EGM: extraordinary general meeting** – a shareholders' meeting to discuss an important issue such as a proposed merger

## C

## How was the meeting?

Some colleagues are discussing a meeting they have just come out of.

Anil: I thought it was very **productive**.

Juliet: Well, I thought it was a **waste of time**. I heard nothing I didn't already know.

Barbara: Well, I agree with Anil. I felt we had some very **useful discussions**. We certainly **covered a lot of ground**. We got through an incredible number of things.

Juliet: As usual John was **rambling** and kept **wandering off the point**. He just uses meetings as a chance to **show off**.

Anil: But to be fair, the chair really **kept things moving** – she encouraged people to **stick to the point** by keeping things brief.



## Exercises

- 55.1** Replace the underlined expressions with appropriate forms of the verbs in A opposite. In some cases, more than one verb is possible.

Eurotunnel owns and operates the tunnel under the English Channel. A meeting for shareholders had been **(1) organized** for 12 July. The company is experiencing financial problems and some shareholders wanted **(2) the meeting to take place before then**, but in the end the meeting was **(3) delayed**. The Paris commercial law court agreed that the meeting should be **(4) moved** to 27 July to allow time for financial rescue plans to be finalized. Eurotunnel's chairman **(5) managed** the meeting very efficiently, and the new financial plans were agreed. Only very few shareholders **(6) did not go to** it.

- 55.2** Look at B opposite. At which type of meeting would you be most likely to hear each of these things?

- 1 I'm pleased to announce another good year for shareholders of this company.
- 2 I know this sounds crazy, but how about giving away 100,000 free samples?
- 3 Things in the sales department are getting out of control. We should all start making a real effort.
- 4 So, you think you can offer 10,000 a month at a unit cost of £4.90?
- 5 Have you heard? Suzanne is being fired. Her sales figures aren't good enough, apparently.
- 6 That's a deal, then. Looking forward to working with you. I'm sure you won't be disappointed.
- 7 Amazingly, we're ahead of schedule on this job.
- 8 I recommend to shareholders that you accept BP's offer for our company.
- 9 As you know, BP wants to buy this company. As chief financial offer, what do you think of their offer, Saleem?



- 55.3** A management consultant is talking about meetings, using expressions from C opposite. Put what she says into the correct order.

- a point and rambling. And then there are those who want to show
- b moving. If they do this, it's amazing how much ground you can cover.
- c Of course, everyone wants meetings to be productive and achieve results. But from personal experience, we know that a lot of them are a waste of
- d off – to show how important and clever they are. The chair should keep things
- e the point. We've all seen those annoying people who keep wandering off the
- f time, and nothing is achieved. In order for discussion to be useful, people should stick to

☐  
☐  
☐  
☐  
☐  
☐

### Over to you

What sort of meetings do you go to in your school or organization? Are they useful?

# 56

## Meetings 2: the chair

### A

#### The role of the chair: before the meeting

A **chairman**, **chairwoman** or **chair** has to be a **good organizer**. What they do before the meeting is as important as the meeting itself. They should ensure that the **agenda** – the list of things to be discussed – is complete by asking those involved what should be on it and then **circulating** – distributing – the agenda to those involved. They should check the **venue**, making sure the room will be free and without interruptions until the end of the meeting.

Note

Don't say **agenda** when you mean **diary**.



### B

#### The role of the chair: running the meeting

The **chairperson** should be a **good timekeeper**. They should start the meeting on time. Don't wait for **latecomers**.

They should appoint a **minute-taker**, someone who makes sure that opinions and **action points** – where participants agree to do something, find something out, etc. – are noted.

The chair should make sure that each participant has the chance to **make their point**.

Disagreements should be dealt with **tactfully** – without annoying people – making sure that each side feels their point of view has been noted. Avoid **digressions** where people **get off the point**.

They should make sure each point on the agenda is **allocated** the time it deserves, perhaps indicating this on the agenda. Even if the current item has not been completely covered or **resolved** – decided – make sure that discussion **moves on to the next point**.

They should ensure that the meeting **finishes on time**, or early.

Let's make a start.

Would you mind taking the minutes, Adam?

I think you wanted to say something about this, Brigitte.

Let's talk about this calmly.

I think we've covered this item.

We can return to this issue at the next meeting.

Let's move on to the next item.

OK. Time's up. Thanks for coming.

### C

#### Follow-up

After some meetings, it's necessary for the minutes from the previous meeting to be circulated, especially if there are **action points** that particular people are responsible for.

At the next meeting, the chair should ask for the minutes to be read out and make sure that all agree that it is an **accurate record** of what happened, and see if there are any **matters arising** – any points from the last meeting that need to be discussed that are not on the agenda of the current meeting. And they should check what progress has been made on the action points of the previous meeting.

## Exercises

- 56.1** This article relates to points in A and B opposite. Read the article and say if the statements below are true or false.

I DON'T KNOW HOW TO CHAIR A MEETING!

*I've been asked to chair a meeting about the Christmas office party, but I'm incredibly nervous as I've never chaired one before. Is there a secret for success?*

You may never have chaired a meeting, but as you've probably been to lots, you'll have seen it done well and badly. Think about the things that please and annoy you, and build on them. Well-run meetings stick to the point, get things decided and finish on time. Make sure everyone has the agenda well in advance, and that you know enough about the participants and issues to be discussed. Arrange for the room to be cool rather than warm; people will be less likely to go to sleep. See yourself as a referee whose job it is to ensure fair play through careful watching and listening. It's up to you to encourage the timid, control the talkative, involve the bored, calm down the argumentative and be kind to the minute-taker you have appointed. Getting that individual on your side is essential if you want the record to reflect your desired outcomes. It's normal to suggest what should be left out from the minutes and how any difficult bits should be phrased. Keep things moving by not letting discussions wander off the subject or get over-long. Get decisions made and recorded, even if it's only to postpone matters until the next meeting. If someone is being difficult, defuse things by offering to continue the discussion personally at a more appropriate time. If the meeting is likely to be more than a couple of hours long, try to include a break at the mid-point; it acts as a marker and stops people getting restless. Aim to leave everyone feeling they have had a chance to say what they wanted to say, and gain lasting and well-deserved popularity by finishing early.

In planning a successful meeting, you should:

- 1 think about meetings you have been to in the past.
- 2 hand out the agenda at the meeting.
- 3 know something about the participants and the things they will be talking about.
- 4 treat every participant in the same way.
- 5 be nice to the person making a record of the meeting.
- 6 allow people to talk for as long they want.
- 7 never talk to participants about particular issues after the meeting is over.

- 56.2** Complete the statements below (1–7) containing expressions from A, B and C opposite with appropriate forms of the verbs that come in front of them.

- 1 Someone who records what is said \_\_\_\_\_ the minutes.
- 2 The chair \_\_\_\_\_ the person in 1 above as the minute-taker.
- 3 If you \_\_\_\_\_ the agenda, you send it out before the meeting.
- 4 The chair should \_\_\_\_\_ the right amount of time for each point.
- 5 When one point has been covered, the meeting should \_\_\_\_\_ to the next point.
- 6 If you want to save time, \_\_\_\_\_ digressions.
- 7 Everyone should \_\_\_\_\_ that the minutes are an accurate record of what happened at the last meeting.

### Over to you

- Are you good at – or would you be good at – chairing meetings? Why? / Why not?
- What do you find annoying in meetings?

## A

## Opening the meeting

Creative Advertising is a US-owned advertising agency with offices in Soho in London. Its chief executive, Carla Eagleton, is opening a meeting with four of the people who work for the company.



OK, let's get started.

As you know, I've called this meeting to discuss the situation in the design department. Until now, the feeling has been that designers are creative types and need the freedom to work as they wish. But things are getting out of control.

You can also say:

- Let's begin, shall we?
- Shall we make a start?
- Let's make a start.
- It's time to get started.
- Let's get down to business.

You can also say:

- I've arranged this meeting to ...
- I've organized this meeting to ...
- The purpose of this meeting is to ...
- The main objective of this meeting is to ...

## B

## Asking for and expressing opinions

Would you like to open the discussion, Piers?

I believe the design department needs a certain amount of freedom, but there are limits. They come in at 10.30 when all other employees have already been at work for two hours. This leads to tensions between design people and other employees.

You can also say:

- Would you like to kick off?
- Would you like to get the ball rolling?

You can also say:

- Personally, I think ...
- My standpoint is that ...

What about you, Maria?

As I see it, I can't run the design department as if it was the accounts department.

- How about you, Maria?
- What do you think, Maria?

- The way I see it ...

In my opinion, they're going much too far. I can't bear to think of the costs involved.

Of course, we are creative, and need to be given the freedom to work how we like.

- It looks/seems to me as if ...
- It's clear to me that ...

- Obviously, ...

## Note

The expression **kick off** comes from football. **Get the ball rolling** does not come from any particular sport.

You use **Of course** and **Obviously** to introduce an idea, but also to show that you think other people will know it or agree with it already. Be careful how you use these expressions, as they can sound rude.



## Exercises

**57.1** Complete the expressions from A and B opposite grouped together below.

- 1 

How ..... about you?
- 2 

I've ..... this meeting to ...
- 3 

Let's ..... ?
- 4 

The (main) ..... of this meeting is to ...
- 5 

It ..... to me as if ...

**57.2** Match the two parts of the expressions from the continuation of the discussion in B opposite.

- |                  |                          |                                                                              |
|------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 The way        | <input type="checkbox"/> | a I think that the prizes we win help us to attract and keep the             |
| 2 Personally,    | <input type="checkbox"/> | best designers.                                                              |
| 3 It looks to me | <input type="checkbox"/> | b as if the design people think of themselves as living on another planet.   |
| 4 It's clear to  | <input type="checkbox"/> | c I see it, you should be looking at what we produce, not at the time of day |
| 5 In my          | <input type="checkbox"/> | we produce it.                                                               |
|                  |                          | d opinion, we have to think of the needs of each department.                 |
|                  |                          | e me that they set a very bad example to the other departments.              |

### Over to you

- How free are people to express their feelings in your organization?
- Are people at all levels encouraged to say what they think?
- Are new employees asked for their opinions?

# 58

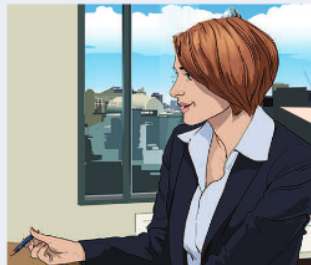
## Meetings 4: agreement and disagreement

### A Agreeing

Carla's meeting (see previous unit) continues.

The phrases in bold can be used when agreeing with people.

**You may be right there.** The budget figures are not looking good. But on the other hand we mustn't forget the other benefits for the company.



**You're perfectly right.** We are the people who are the driving force behind the company.

You can also say:

- a **I couldn't agree more.** We got our latest recruits after we won the Advertising Industry Award for best advertisement last year.
- b **Precisely.** Creativity comes to some of our people in the middle of the night.
- c **Exactly.** It's the creative people who bring in all the money.
- d **Absolutely.** It's the output that counts.

You can also say:

- e **That's true, I suppose.** But we must think of the company as a whole.
- f **I suppose so.** But other employees mustn't be forgotten.

### B Disagreeing

**That's not really how I see it.** Designers and accounts people are all company employees.



**I think you're wrong.** The design department's costs are justified because of our high-quality work. The costs of the other departments are not justified.

You can also say:

- g **I don't really agree.** The prizes that the designers get are important, but people would come to work for us anyway.
- h **I can't go along with you there.** I think we need to see people at their desks actually working.
- i **I think you're mistaken.** If the designers get to work late, they should be disciplined.
- j **I'm afraid I can't agree with you there.** We all depend on each other for the company to make money.
- k **I'm sorry, but that's out of the question.** All employees should keep to normal working hours.

You can also say:

- l **Of course not.** The latest figures I've seen show that the project is within budget.
- m **That's absurd.** You can't expect us to leave at 10 in the evening and be back at 8 in the morning.
- n **That's ridiculous.** Each department has very specific needs.

Note

Be careful with **That's absurd**, **That's ridiculous** and **Of course not**.

These expressions are very strong and can be offensive.

## Exercises

**58.1** Put the expressions in A and B opposite into the following groups:

- |                     |                       |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| 1 mild agreement    | 3 strong agreement    |
| 2 mild disagreement | 4 strong disagreement |

**58.2** The expressions below follow on immediately from those in A opposite. Match the continuations (1–6) with the expressions (a–f).

- 1 We don't care about the hours that each person in our department works.
- 2 Besides that, the prizes help us to attract and keep the best designers.
- 3 Not only do we have these very high costs, but it also sets a very bad example to the other departments and they start going over budget too.
- 4 We're all in this together.
- 5 Without us, there would be no profits.
- 6 You should be looking at what we produce, not at the time of day we produce it.

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**58.3** Two advertising managers, Georgina and Henry, are exchanging opinions. Use expressions from B opposite (g–n) containing the word in brackets to complete what Henry says. Then match what Georgina says with Henry's replies.

| Georgina                                                                                                       | Henry                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 The agency should move its offices out of Soho to the suburbs somewhere.                                     | ..... (absurd).<br>We would lose employees to our competitors if we cut salaries.  |
| 2 Times are difficult and everyone should take a 10 per cent pay cut.                                          | ..... (along).<br>The agency is at its most creative now.                          |
| 3 The real problem is the number of unproductive people in the agency.                                         | ..... (ridiculous). We need to stay in the creative heart of London.               |
| 4 When they travel on business, everyone should stay at the same low-cost hotels in order to cut costs.        | ..... (afraid).<br>People need to get away from their offices sometimes.           |
| 5 One reason for our high costs is employees who go out for coffee in the local bars twice a day.              | ..... (really).<br>Other advertising agencies are doing well, despite the economy. |
| 6 If the agency's less profitable than it was, it's because economic conditions are terrible.                  | ..... (course).<br>Everyone in the agency works hard.                              |
| 7 If we could get back to the creativity we had when the agency was founded, all our problems would be solved. | ..... (course).<br>Everyone in the agency works hard.                              |
|                                                                                                                | ..... (question).<br>Some of the accommodation is really bad.                      |

### Over to you

- Is it acceptable for people to disagree openly with each other in your company/country?
- Do you prefer to avoid arguments?

## A

**Interrupting, referring back, checking understanding, avoiding confrontation**

Here are some other expressions used in meetings for different purposes.

To interrupt someone politely:

- If I can just stop you for a moment.
- Can I (just) come in here?
- Sorry to interrupt you, but ...

To check that you understand what someone has said:

- Are you saying that ... ?
- Are you suggesting that ... ?
- If I understand (you) correctly, ...
- If I follow you, ...

To refer back to what was said earlier:

- To go back to what you were saying earlier ...
- As we were saying earlier ...
- To go back to what I was just saying ...

To avoid direct **confrontation** – disagreement:

- I take your point ...
- I understand what you're saying ...
- I see/know what you mean, but ...
- I hear where you're coming from on this, but ...

## B

**Agreement, consensus or compromise?**

An **agreement** is when people **agree about** or **on** something.

A **compromise** is an agreement where each side accepts less than it wanted – they each have to **compromise**.

A **consensus** is a situation where most people agree about something.

If people **have a disagreement about** something, they **disagree about** it.

Note

All the nouns above can be countable and uncountable. You can **come to**, **reach** or **find agreement** or **an agreement** (with someone). The same verbs can be used with **compromise** and **consensus**. If you disagree (with someone), you have a **disagreement** (with them).



## C

**Concluding**

- We've covered a lot of ground.
- It's been a very interesting discussion.
- We're running out of time.
- To go over what's been said ...
- To sum up ...
- We're going to have to agree to disagree.
- Unless anyone has anything else to add ...
- We're going to have to stop there.
- I think that's it.
- Thank you all for coming.



## Exercises

**59.1** Use complete expressions from A opposite to complete the dialogue, based on the prompts in brackets. The first one has been done for you.

A: We really will have to increase productivity.

B: (coming), but there are limits to how much we can ask of each individual employee. After all, if you look back at the records for ...

I hear where you're coming from on this, but ...

A: (stop), you have to admit things were different then. That was in the late 1990s.

B: (understand), but that's not so long ago. The pressures were the same.

C: (go back), there are limits as to what we can ask from the creatives. They ...

A: (interrupt), but I hate that word 'creative'. A lot of them have created nothing except chaos since they arrived in the company.

C: (suggest) that the creative department has people who shouldn't be there?

**59.2** Use the information in B opposite to complete the table below.

| Countable noun | Uncountable noun also? | Verb | Expression                               |
|----------------|------------------------|------|------------------------------------------|
| agreement      |                        |      | ..... / ..... / ..... (.....) agreement  |
| disagreement   |                        |      | ..... disagreement                       |
| compromise     |                        |      | ..... / ..... / ..... (.....) compromise |
| consensus      |                        |      | ..... / ..... / ..... (.....) consensus  |

**59.3** Look at C opposite and put the extracts from this newspaper report into the correct order.

- a out of time and we're going to have to stop there. I'll let you know the committee's decision about the solution to this problem by the end of the month.
- b There were strong differences of opinion at last night's meeting to discuss banning cars from the centre of Cambridge. The chair, Ms Yolanda Johns of the town council's transport committee, organized the meeting well. At the end of the meeting she said, 'We've covered
- c They said it would improve the quality of life. It was not possible to come to
- d a lot of ground and I've listened to both sides of the argument. To sum up the arguments, there were those who thought that banning cars would damage shops and businesses in the town.' Others disagreed.
- e a compromise or consensus. There was total disagreement. After four hours of heated discussion, Ms Johns said, 'It's been a very interesting discussion but we're running

### Over to you

In your organization, are decisions based on compromise and consensus – or are they imposed from above? Give an example.

**A Types of presentation**

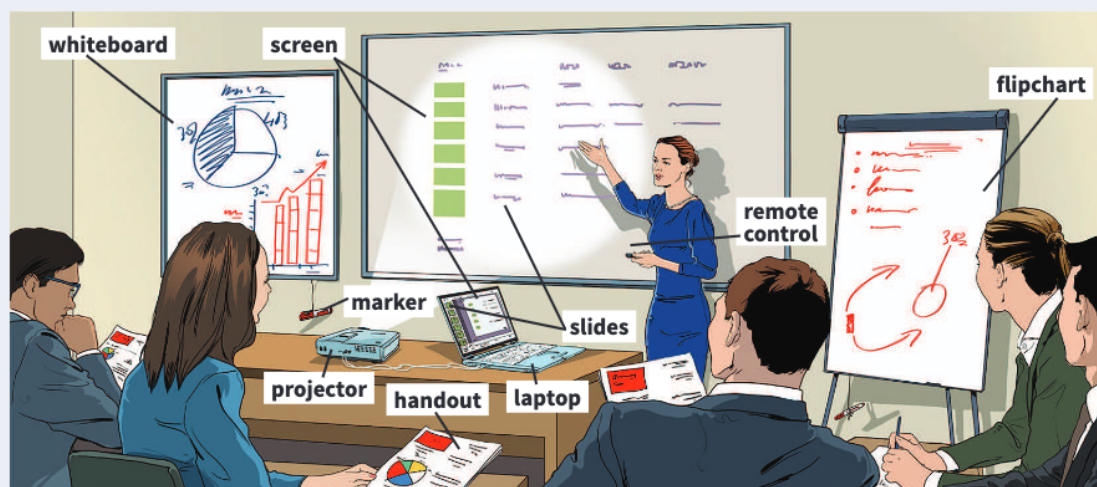
Here are some examples of business presentations.

- a **press conference** – the chief executives of two companies tell journalists why their companies have merged
- b **demonstration** – the head of research and development gives a presentation to non-technical colleagues about a new machine that the research and development department has just completed
- c **product launch** – a car company announces a new model
- d **workshop** – company employees do practical exercises on time management
- e **seminar** – a financial adviser gives advice to people about investments

**B What makes a good presentation?**

A presentation, and the **presenter**, the person giving it, are usually judged by:

- 1 The way the presentation is **organized**:
  - The **ideas** and the **visual aids** (pictures, charts and data designed to help people understand or remember particular information) are **clearly structured** – easy to follow
  - how the information is mixed with **interesting examples and stories** – people want to hear how the presenter relates personally to the subject
- 2 The way the presentation is **delivered**:
  - **rapport** with the audience – members feel that the presenter understands them
  - **eye contact** – the way the presenter looks at the audience
  - **loud enough** voice
  - **variety** in your **tone of voice** – it's important not to speak in a monotone and to vary the **speed** that you speak at
- 3 The way the presenter **feels** about the topic, the audience and himself/herself:
  - **confident** and **relaxed look**
  - **enthusiastic** about the topic
  - **positive attitude**
  - **interested in** the audience and getting them **involved** – participating in their minds

**C Presentation tools and visual aids**

## Exercises

**60.1** Match the presentation types in A opposite with things that people say in them below:

- 1 Each group has a series of problems faced by a company. I want you to suggest solutions.
- 2 Now is the right time to get out of company shares and invest in property.
- 3 The combined resources of our two organizations will allow us to achieve great things.
- 4 The X300 has the most advanced features of any car in its class.
- 5 As you can see, this prototype is far in advance of anything we have done before.

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**60.2** Look at B and C opposite. Then read the article and answer the questions.



[Home](#)
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[World](#)
[Business](#)
[Food](#)
[Technology](#)
[Science](#)

### Making Sure You Get The Message Across

Your mouth is dry, your voice trembles, your hands shake and you can hear your heart thudding – yes, you are making a presentation. No matter what job we do, most of us will sooner or later have to make one, whether it is delivering a goodbye speech, explaining a project to bosses, or trying to get new business.

Khalid Aziz, of the Aziz Corporation, which teaches senior executives to communicate, says: 'About 60 per cent of the effectiveness of a spoken presentation is nothing to do with the words. It's to do with style, confident body language and the right speed of delivery.' Management consultant Terry Gillen says: 'Your presentation should have a main theme, a single powerful message. It should have a clear structure, with each point leading to the next. Human brains automatically try to organise information received, so if your presentation does not have a structure, your audience will create its own. Attention will wander and listeners may get the wrong idea. And if you structure your presentation, it will be easy for you to remember.' But Mr Gillen warns: 'Reading from a document, whether it's the whole speech or detailed notes, sounds formal and stiff, and switches the audience off.'

Presenters should encourage passive and active audience participation to personalise the message and keep people listening. Mr Gillen says: 'Use phrases such as "What would you think if ...". Encourage them to ask questions or, if you are demonstrating something, get them to join in. They'll do this only if you look friendly and smile. Make eye contact and maybe enter the audience's territory rather than staying stuck behind your desk.' He adds: 'The audience want to enjoy the presentation and are more likely to do so if the presenter also appears to be enjoying it. Nerves and anxiety often show. Audiences notice uncomfortable body language and hesitant speech.' Mr Aziz says: 'Minimise panic by steering clear of coffee for at least two hours before. Practise and rehearse, and visit the venue to remove the fear of the unknown. Beware of complex visual aids which confuse and distract attention from the message, and add extra information with your voice.'

NatWest corporate manager Deborah Buckle, 32, learned to 'Present with Passion' after attending one of Khalid Aziz's courses. Deborah, of Surrey, says: 'Knowing your stuff is not enough. You have to enthuse your audience. I also learned that, unless you're careful, the message received is not always the one given.'

Comment
  Like

- 1 Which points in B opposite does Khalid Aziz refer to?
- 2 Which point in B does Terry Gillen refer to?
- 3 Is reading from a prepared text a good idea? Why? / Why not?
- 4 For Terry Gillen, what are four ways of getting audience involvement?
- 5 For Khalid Aziz, what are two ways of avoiding panic, and one way of using visuals well?
- 6 What is the most important thing about presentations for Deborah Buckle?
- 7 She says that 'the message received is not always the one given'. Where is this idea referred to previously in the article?

### Over to you

- Do you ever give presentations? What type are they? Who are the audiences?
- In your experience, what makes a good presentation?

# 61

## Presentations 2: key steps

### A Key steps: introduction

Anne-Marie Duval works for a firm of management consultants. She is responsible for recruiting consultants for the firm. She has been invited as a guest speaker to an international conference in Cannes to talk about the subject of recruitment.

- a **My name's** Anne-Marie Duval and I work for Gem Consultants.
- b **It's very nice to see so many of you here** in Cannes on such a sunny day!
- c **I'm going to talk about** 'Consultancy Skills for the 21st Century'.
- d **There are three main areas** I want to look at today.
- e **If you have any questions**, I'll be very happy to answer them at the end of the session.



### B Key steps: main part

**OK. To begin with, let's look at** the first type of skills that consultants need: technical skills. Of course, **related to** technical skills, you need good general knowledge of management subjects.

**That's all I have time for** on technical skills. **Let's move on** to the second area: interpersonal skills. **As you can see** on this slide, there are two **key areas in relation to** interpersonal skills. And **as this transparency shows**, interpersonal skills are complex.

I think **that covers everything on** interpersonal skills. **Time is moving on**, so **let's turn to** the third area: people management issues. This is **the third and most important area** that I want to talk about today.

OK, **that's all I have to say on/about** the key area of people-management issues.

### C Key steps: closing

Let me just **sum up**. **Firstly**, we looked at technical skills, **secondly**, interpersonal skills and **last but not least**, people management issues. In fact, the secret for success in the future is going to be, **in my view**, these people-management issues. **That brings me to the end** of my presentation. **Are there any questions?**



## Exercises

**61.1** Match the expressions (a–e) in A opposite with what the speaker is doing (1–5).

- 1 interacts with audience by showing she knows where she is and saying what she thinks of the place
- 2 identifies herself
- 3 tells the audience when she will answer questions
- 4 announces the title of her talk
- 5 says how it will be structured

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**61.2** Look at B opposite and correct the mistakes below, from another presentation. There is one mistake in each item.

- 1 To begin with, let we look at the most basic product in our range.
- 2 Of course, you will certainly have lots of questions in relation with the product specifications of our basic model.
- 3 That's all I'm having time for on product specifications.
- 4 Let's to move on to our mid-range model.
- 5 As this transparency is showing, there are two key features I want to talk about in relation to our mid-range model.
- 6 I think that cover everything on our mid-range model.
- 7 Our top-of-the-range product is the third and more important model I want to talk about.

**61.3** Look at C opposite. Is the presenter using the **bold** expressions in the correct place? Why? / Why not?

- 1 **Are there any questions?** There are three main areas I want to talk about: one – old products, two – new products and three – ideas that are currently under development.
- 2 Let me just **sum up** as I've covered the three things I wanted to talk about and we're getting near the end of our time.
- 3 Firstly, we looked at technical skills, secondly, interpersonal skills and **last but not least**, people management issues.
- 4 **That brings me to the end of my presentation** and fourthly there are the financial aspects and I'm going to spend 20 minutes on them now.
- 5 In fact, the secret for success in the future is going to be, **in my view**, these people management issues. Of course, other experts in the field have different opinions on this.



### Over to you

Think of your last presentation.

- What was it about?
- What went well?
- Did it have a good introduction, a good main part and a good closing?
- What would you change next time?

## A

**Closing and dealing with questions**

Anne-Marie is bringing her presentation (see Unit 61) to a close and invites questions from the audience.

**That brings me to the end of my presentation. Are there any questions?**



These are her answers to some of the questions.

a **That's a fair point.** I know that some consultants don't have a very good image. But I think that the results from our organization, Gem Consultants, speak for themselves. I can give you examples of enormously reduced costs or increased profits at companies that have used our services ...

b **That's confidential.** I'm afraid I can't tell you.

c **That's not really my field.** But I can put you in touch with someone in my organization who is working on internet applications.

d **The questioner would like to know** what sort of background the people we recruit usually have. Is that right? Well, we recruit some of our consultants straight out of business school, but mainly ...

e **Well, I think that goes beyond the scope of today's presentation.**

Today I wanted to concentrate on consultants' skills, not go into particular case studies in consultancy. Well, we've run out of time and I think that's a good place to stop.

f **I'm afraid we've run out of time.** But if you'd like to come and discuss that with me now, I'll try and give you an answer. **I think that's a good place to stop. Thank you for listening.**

## B

**Intercultural aspects**

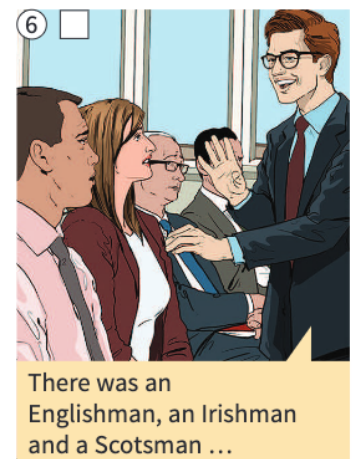
- a Avoid **mannerisms** – irritating ways of moving and speaking – such as overusing 'Er ...'.
- b Be careful with **humour**. For example, don't make jokes about people in the audience.
- c **Dress** formally unless you know for sure that the occasion is informal.
- d Maintain **eye contact** by looking round the room at each person in the audience for about a second, before moving on to the next person. Don't concentrate on just one or two people.
- e **Face the audience** at all times: don't speak to the equipment or the screen.
- f **Remain standing**: don't sit. Stay more or less in one place and don't move around too much.
- g **Smiling** is fine at appropriate moments, but not too much: it can seem **insincere** – as if you don't mean it.
- h Use **gesture** – hand movements – to emphasize key points. Point with your whole hand, rather than just one finger.
- i **Respect the audience**. Don't make exaggerated claims – don't say things are better than they really are.

## Exercises

**62.1** Match these questions (1–6) from the audience with the answers (a–f) that Anne-Marie gives in A opposite.

- 1 Sorry, but I didn't hear the end of the question – could you repeat what the questioner said? ☐
- 2 In what ways do you think the internet is going to change the way management consultants work in the future? ☐
- 3 Some companies refuse to use management consultants. What do you say to people who say that consultants are a waste of time and money? ☐
- 4 What's the average salary for your consultants? ☐
- 5 I don't know if you have time to answer this, but can you tell me how I can apply to work for Gem? ☐
- 6 You say that Gem have enormously increased profits at some companies. Can you give one or two examples of this? ☐

**62.2** Look at this presentation that a sales person gave to potential customers. Match his mistakes with the points in B opposite.



### Over to you

- How is body language used in presentations in your country? Which gestures are acceptable and which are not?
- Which of the things mentioned in B opposite do you find the most annoying? Why?



## A

**Types of negotiation**

If people **negotiate (with each other)**, they talk in order to reach an agreement which is to their **mutual advantage** – good for them both. Examples of these situations in business are:

- a **customer–supplier negotiations**
- b **wage negotiations**
- c **merger or takeover negotiations**  
(see Unit 34)
- d **trade negotiations**
- e Negotiations also take place to **settle disputes** – decide arguments.
- f **contract disputes**
- g **labour disputes**
- h **trade disputes**



## B

**Word combinations with ‘negotiations’**

|                      |                       |                                                                              |
|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Intense</b>       | } <b>negotiations</b> | are very difficult and tiring, with a lot being discussed.                   |
| <b>Intensive</b>     |                       |                                                                              |
| <b>Delicate</b>      |                       | are very difficult and could easily fail.                                    |
| <b>Tense</b>         |                       |                                                                              |
| <b>Eleventh-hour</b> |                       | take place very late in relation to the time that an agreement is necessary. |
| <b>Last-minute</b>   |                       |                                                                              |
| <b>Protracted</b>    |                       | take a very long time.                                                       |

## Note

**Intense** is about twice as frequent as **intensive** in this context.



Someone who takes part in negotiations is a **negotiator**. A **tough negotiator** is someone who is good at getting what they want, but could be difficult to deal with.

## C

**Bargaining**

To **bargain** is to discuss and agree the price of something. Someone who does this is a **bargainer**.

**Bargaining** is used to talk about pay negotiations, especially in phrases like **collective bargaining**, **pay bargaining**, **wage bargaining**.

All these refer to discussions between groups of employees and their employers about pay and conditions.

**Bargaining** is also often used in these combinations.

|                   |                  |                                                                       |
|-------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>bargaining</b> | <b>tactic</b>    | a particular technique used by a negotiator                           |
|                   | <b>ploy</b>      | a technique used by a negotiator that might be considered as unfair   |
|                   | <b>chip tool</b> | an issue that a negotiator uses in order to gain an advantage         |
|                   | <b>point</b>     | a particular issue that a negotiator discusses                        |
|                   | <b>power</b>     | the degree to which one side is strong enough to obtain what it wants |
|                   | <b>process</b>   | the way that negotiations develop                                     |



## Exercises

**63.1** Match these headlines (1–7) with the situations (a–g) in A opposite.

1 **CAR WORKERS IN TWO-YEAR PAY DEAL TALKS WITH FORD**

2 **FRANCE BANS US FILMS FOLLOWING TALKS BREAKDOWN**

3 **WORLD TRADE ORGANIZATION MEMBERS IN WIDE-RANGING DISCUSSIONS**

4 **PHARMACEUTICALS GIANTS SAY THAT COMBINING WOULD BE 'TO THEIR MUTUAL ADVANTAGE'**

5 **AIRLINES ATTACK AIRBUS FOR LATE AIRCRAFT DELIVERIES**

6 **EMPLOYERS REFUSE TO NEGOTIATE WITH STRIKING MINERS**

7 **EDUCATION MINISTRY AND HP IN 'COMPUTER ON EVERY DESK' TALKS**

**63.2** Match the two parts of these extracts containing expressions from B opposite.

1 After 48 hours of intensive

2 After tense

3 The agreement on limiting television violence represents the climax of several months of intense

4 Then violence broke out and it took six months of delicate

5 The deal was struck only after eleventh-hour

a negotiations between the hijackers and air traffic control in Cyprus, the plane was allowed to land at Larnaca airport.

b negotiations between the US, the European Union and Japan.

c negotiations in which he slept for only one hour, Mr Prescott said, 'It has been both tough and incredibly complicated.'

d negotiations to put the process back on track.

e negotiations between television executives and the National Parent-Teacher Association.

**63.3** Complete what an employee representative says with expressions from C opposite.

- Last night, we were talking with employers until 3 am, but it wasn't really necessary – they were trying to tire us out. It was just a .....
- When unemployment is low, we can be more demanding. We have more .....
- When neither side is aggressive, things go much better. It improves the whole .....
- The most difficult area is negotiating what employees are going to be earning next year, what's called ..... (3 expressions).
- It's good when you have a piece of information that the other side don't have. It can turn out to be a useful ..... (2 expressions).
- I usually get what I want. I'm a pretty good .....

### Over to you

- Do you have to negotiate? Do you like it? Why? / Why not?
- What qualities make a good negotiator?

## A

## Preparing to negotiate

When you're going to negotiate, it's important not to rush into things.

- a Get as much information as possible about the situation. If you are dealing with people from another culture, find out about its **negotiating styles**<sup>1</sup> and **etiquette**<sup>2</sup>, and so on. The more you can find out, the better!
- b Work out what your **needs and objectives**<sup>3</sup> are. This gives you your initial **bargaining position**<sup>4</sup>.
- c Try to estimate the needs and objectives of the other side.
- d Prepare a **fallback position**<sup>5</sup>.

- e Perhaps you are in a position to influence the choice of **venue**<sup>6</sup>. If so, decide whether you prefer:

- to be **on your own ground**<sup>7</sup>
- to go and see the other side **on their ground**<sup>8</sup>
- to meet on **neutral ground**<sup>9</sup>, for example in a hotel.

- f If you are negotiating as part of a **negotiating team**<sup>10</sup>, consult the other members of the team about the points above. Allocate **roles and responsibilities**<sup>11</sup>.

<sup>1</sup>the way they negotiate

<sup>2</sup>what they consider to be acceptable and unacceptable behaviour

<sup>3</sup>the things that you want to achieve

<sup>4</sup>conditions that you will accept

<sup>5</sup>conditions that you will accept if the aims you have at the beginning are not met

<sup>6</sup>the place where you are going to meet

<sup>7</sup>in your own offices

<sup>8</sup>in their offices

<sup>9</sup>neither your office nor their office

<sup>10</sup>team that is negotiating

<sup>11</sup>who is going to do what

## B

## Opening the negotiation

Linhas Transatlanticas (LT) is negotiating to buy a number of D740 planes from EPA. Frederica Ramos, LT's chief executive, is talking to Tom Lang, EPA's chief salesman. Here are some of the things she says:

- a Mr Lang, **good to see you again. How are you? Let me introduce** my colleagues: Sandra Lopes, our head of finance, and this is Fernando dos Santos, head of operations here at LT.
- b **Would you like some** coffee or tea, or would you prefer juice? How was the flight?
- c **Shall we** go to the conference room and make a start?
- d You told me you're flying back on Friday evening, so that gives us three days. I think two days should be enough to cover all the points. On the third day, Friday, **if** we have an agreement, **I'll** ask our lawyers to check it.
- e **As you all probably know**, Mr Lang and I met at the Aerospace Trade Fair in Frankfurt last year and we had a very interesting discussion about the possibility of buying a number of D740s from EPA.
- f **Well, we've** looked at the potential requirements for the new plane and it looks as if we may need 100 new planes over the next five years.



## C

## Negotiating styles

When you're negotiating with people from other cultures, it's important to think about what they consider as 'normal' behaviour. Think about these areas:

- a **body language** – the way you hold your body, the gestures you make, etc.
- b **conversational rules** – the acceptability of silence, interrupting others, etc.
- c **hierarchy** – awareness of and respect for the relative importance of people on both sides
- d **physical contact** – the degree to which it's acceptable to touch someone's shoulder, for example, to make a point
- e **relationship building** – how important it is for participants to get to 'know' the other side
- f **attitude to time** – do you get down to business immediately, or do you spend some time on 'small talk'?

## Exercises

- 64.1** Tom Lang is EPA's chief salesman. He is hoping to sell a number of 740s to Linhas Transatlanticas (LT) over the next few years. He and his colleagues are meeting LT executives soon, and he is preparing for the negotiations. Match each point in the preparation notes he makes (1-6) with one of the points (a-f) in A opposite.

- |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Organize preparatory meeting with our head of manufacturing and head of financing to discuss strategy. <input type="checkbox"/>                              | 4 Rumours that airlines are having problems borrowing money from banks for plane purchases - find out more about this. <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2 Agree to go to LT's offices in Rio de Janeiro. <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                      | 5 Will accept price of €260 million per aircraft if order is for 30 or more. <input type="checkbox"/>                                           |
| 3 Principal objective: delivery of first 20 planes in 2 years, not earlier; other objectives: get full price on each of €270 million. <input type="checkbox"/> | 6 Find out more about Brazilian business etiquette! <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                    |

- 64.2** Match these points (1-6) with what Frederica Ramos says (a-f) in B opposite.

- 1 Go to the meeting room and suggest that you get down to business. ☐



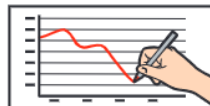
- 2 Have a clear agenda and a timetable. ☐



- 3 Offer coffee and small talk. Try to create a relaxed atmosphere. ☐



- 4 Give the background to the negotiations. Just talking about the situation is a good way of reminding people of key facts and issues. ☐



- 5 Start the actual negotiations, perhaps by finding out more about the priorities of the other side - the things they think are most important - or talking about your own requirements. ☐



- 6 Greet representatives of the other company, introducing your colleagues. Everybody should be clear about who everyone is. ☐



- 64.3** Alonso, a representative of Alpha Ltd, is in another country in order to try to get a multimillion-dollar order from Beta Inc, represented by Brian (the most senior), and Belinda and Birgit (who work under Brian). Match each problem with one of the headings in C opposite.

- Alonso wanted to start the negotiations immediately, but Brian suggested a sightseeing tour of the city where Beta is based, and the next day, a game of golf. ☐
- At the start of the meeting, Brian asked Alonso about his flight and the hotel. ☐
- When Alonso made an important point, Brian was silent for two minutes before replying. This made Alonso very nervous. ☐
- When he was talking, Alonso looked directly at Brian, Belinda and Birgit in turn, giving them equal attention. Brian started to look annoyed. ☐
- During a coffee break, Alonso put his arm around Brian's shoulders in order to be 'friendly'. ☐
- When Belinda or Birgit were talking, Brian frequently tapped his fingers on the table. ☐

### Over to you

- What are the normal 'rules' in your country for a buyer-customer negotiation?
- Give one or two tips to a business person visiting your country in order to negotiate.

## A

## Probing

The idea with **win-win** is that in negotiations there shouldn't be winners and losers. The negotiators try to reach a **win-win solution** – an agreement of equal benefit to them both.

One way of starting out is **probing** – asking the right questions and listening carefully to the answers – to find out more about the objectives of the other side, in order to build on the information you collected before the negotiation.

a **What is the situation on** production at your plant at the moment?

b **What sort of** quantities **are you looking for?**

c **What are we looking at in the way of** a discount?

d **What did you have in mind regarding** specifications?

e **What were you thinking of in terms of** delivery dates?

f **How important to you** is the currency for payment?

## B

## Positive positions

Through a series of **proposals** or **offers** and **counter-proposals** or **counter-offers** from the other side, the two sides work towards an agreement that will benefit them both.

- 1 **If you offer** more attractive financing, **we will be able to** increase our order.
- 2 **As long as** the planes are delivered on time, **we could consider** ordering more in the future.
- 3 **On condition that** you deliver 20 planes by May, **we will start** negotiating a second order then.
- 4 **Supposing that** you provide good technical support, **we may be prepared** to pay a higher price.
- 5 **Provided** you understand our immediate needs, **we might agree** to later delivery of some of the planes.

Note

Notice that you use the **-ing** form after **consider**. You can also use the **-ing** form (as well as the infinitive) after **start**.

You can say **provided (that)** and **providing (that)**: **that** is optional with both.



## C

## Negative positions

These can be expressed with 'if' or 'unless'.

- |                           |   |                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 <b>If you don't</b>     | } | <b>reduce the price</b> , we will go elsewhere.                                          |
| <b>Unless you</b>         |   |                                                                                          |
| 2 <b>If you fail to</b>   | } | <b>deliver</b> on time, we will go to a commercial court for compensation.               |
| <b>Unless you</b>         |   |                                                                                          |
| 3 <b>If you can't</b>     | } | <b>sort out</b> the technical problems, we will cancel our order.                        |
| <b>Unless you</b>         |   |                                                                                          |
| 4 <b>If you refuse to</b> | } | <b>take account of</b> the issues we've mentioned, we won't continue these negotiations. |
| <b>Unless you</b>         |   |                                                                                          |

## D

## Concessions and trade-offs

When you offer to change your position to one that is less favourable to yourself, you **concede** something or **make a concession**. A series of concessions in exchange for concessions from the other side is a series of **trade-offs**.

Even in a friendly negotiation, there may be **horse-trading**, with each side making a series of concessions. (This expression is often used to show disapproval.)



## Exercises

**65.1** Match the replies (1–6) with the probing questions (a–f) in A opposite.

- |                                                                 |                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1 In the long term, perhaps 100 units per year over five years. | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2 We can offer 10 per cent if the quantities are right.         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3 We'd like to see a 10 per cent improvement in performance     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4 We'd prefer US dollars.                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5 We'll need the first 30 planes in 18 months.                  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 6 We're operating at full capacity.                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**65.2** The EPA–LT negotiations in 64.1 and 64.2 have reached a stage where each side is making proposals and counter-proposals. Use expressions and structures from the item with the same number in B opposite to complete the phrases below, using the correct form of the words in brackets. The first one has been done for you.

- offer more flexible payment conditions / be able / (pay) / higher price  
*If you offer more flexible payment conditions, we will be able to pay a higher price.*
- guarantee increased fuel economy / could consider / (pay) €25.5 million per unit
- you sign the agreement today / will / start / (deliver) the planes / July (2 expressions)
- send us your personnel for training / may / prepared (add) special features / to the planes that you order
- accept our conditions / might agree / (work) / you / future (2 expressions)

**65.3** Change these expressions from C opposite and others so that they begin with 'Unless'. The first one has been done for you.

- If you don't reduce the price, we will contact Boeing to see what they have to offer.  
*Unless you reduce the price, we will contact Boeing to see what they have to offer.*
- If you fail to consider our particular requirements, we will end these discussions.
- If you can't deal with our order as a priority, we will cancel it.
- If you are unable to offer more environmentally friendly versions, we will go to see your competitor.
- If you don't stop using unfair techniques, we will break off negotiations.

**65.4** Use appropriate forms of expressions from D opposite to complete these extracts. Use each expression once only.

- Management has made ..... in return for the withdrawal of the shareholders' proposal to fire the entire board of directors.
- Diplomats and oil executives believe a compromise could be reached through intensive horse .....
- The contract negotiating strategy will be based on the ..... between time, cost and quality, and attitude to risk.
- Parkside had been passing on price increases to customers, but in May was forced to ..... a 10 per cent cut to its largest customer.

### Over to you

- Is every negotiation potentially a win-win one?
- Have you ever needed to make concessions? When, and how?

## A

## Deadlock and mediators

## BASEBALL STRIKE

Every year in the US there are negotiations between the baseball players' union and the baseball team owners about pay and conditions for the coming season. One year, after months of negotiations, there was **deadlock**<sup>1</sup> and the negotiations **broke down**<sup>2</sup>. Some commentators said there was **stalemate**<sup>3</sup>; others, an **impasse**<sup>4</sup>. There were **irreconcilable differences**<sup>5</sup> between the two sides and it was impossible to reach an agreement. The baseball players went on strike. The two sides agreed to bring in a **mediator**<sup>6</sup> and the process of **mediation**<sup>7</sup> began. The person they chose

was a retired politician. His role was not to **impose**<sup>8</sup> an agreement. He recommended a **cooling-off period**<sup>9</sup>. The players ended their strike, for the time being at least. Another month passed, and still there was no progress. The two sides said they would accept an agreement imposed by an **arbitrator**<sup>10</sup>. A judge, who also loved baseball, was chosen. She looked at the claims of each side and imposed a **settlement**<sup>11</sup> or a **resolution**<sup>11</sup> to the dispute, fixing the salaries and the working conditions of the players for the coming season. The public was glad that **arbitration**<sup>12</sup> had settled the dispute. Baseball matches continued and life returned to normal.

<sup>1</sup>the situation was completely stuck

<sup>2</sup>failed because there was a problem

<sup>3</sup>a situation in which neither group of people can win

<sup>4</sup>a situation where no progress could be made

<sup>5</sup>it was impossible to find agreement between the two sides

<sup>6</sup>someone from outside to help restart the negotiations and bring the two sides closer together

<sup>7</sup>helping the two sides to agree

<sup>8</sup>force

<sup>9</sup>a period where each side would take no action against the other for a certain period of time

<sup>10</sup>a person who has been chosen to make a decision

<sup>11</sup>an arrangement to end the disagreement

<sup>12</sup>the process of solving a disagreement between two groups of people

## B

## Agreements and contracts

An agreement of any kind is a **deal**. When you reach an agreement, you can talk about **closing a deal** or **clinching a deal**.

Note

**Close a deal** is more frequent than **clinch a deal**.



A **bargain** is also an agreement reached through negotiation. People who get what they want in a negotiation and make few concessions are said to **drive a hard bargain**.

An agreement may be in the form of a **contract**.

|      |   |                          |                   |                                                                                                         |
|------|---|--------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A/An | { | <b>employment labour</b> | } <b>contract</b> | is about what someone has to do in their job, or about what a particular group of employees have to do. |
|      |   | <b>commercial</b>        |                   | relates to a business agreement.                                                                        |
|      |   | <b>oral verbal</b>       |                   | is not written down.                                                                                    |
|      |   | <b>(legally) binding</b> |                   | forces both sides by law to carry out the actions that they had promised to carry out.                  |
|      |   | <b>lucrative</b>         |                   | is very profitable for a supplier or employee.                                                          |

## C

## Checking the deal

It's important to check the points of an agreement to avoid misunderstandings. You could say:

- **Let me just go/run over** – repeat and summarize – the main points.
- **On A**, we agreed that ...
- **As far as B is concerned**, – In relation to B, – we agreed ...
- **We still have the question of C to settle** – decide and agree on.
- And there's still the **outstanding** – remaining undecided – **issue** of D.
- We'll send you a **written proposal**.
- We'll **draw up** – write – a **contract** based on those points.
- **I think that covers everything.**

## Exercises

- 66.1** Look at the words from A opposite and say if these statements are true or false.
- Someone who helps two sides to reach an agreement is an arbitrator.
  - If two sides in a dispute use arbitration, no outsiders are involved.
  - It's not usual for mediators to impose agreements.
  - If you're in an impasse, you think that progress is possible.
  - If negotiations break down, they stop, at least for a time.
  - Irreconcilable differences are not important.
  - If the two sides agree on a cooling-off period of one week, negotiations continue the next day.



- 66.2** Complete these extracts using words that can come in front of 'contract' from B opposite.

- Buyer and seller enter into a legally ..... contract once an offer has been accepted.
- DAF is bidding for a ..... contract to supply trucks to the British army.
- If two people agree on something and sign a sheet of paper, is that a ..... contract?
- Peters claimed that Schaffer was an employee in real estate ventures of Peters's company, but Schaffer asserted that an unwritten, ..... contract made them partners.
- She had an ..... contract due to expire later in the year and wanted to take time off work.

- 66.3** The EPA-LT negotiations are ending. Arrange the phrases that Frederica Ramos uses to close the negotiations into the correct order. The first one is a.

- I'll just run over the main points. On the issue of the numbers of planes we wish to order,
- I think that covers everything. That's it for today.
- If we agree to the proposal, you'll draw up a contract based on those points.
- payment to settle, and there is also still the outstanding issue of documentation.
- we agreed that you would install the most economical Rolls-Royce engines now available.
- we agreed that you would supply us with 120 planes over four years. As far as fuel economy is concerned,
- We still have the question of the currency for
- You agreed to send us a written proposal on these last two issues.

|   |
|---|
| 1 |
|   |
|   |
|   |
|   |
|   |
|   |
|   |

### Over to you

- When would you drive a hard bargain?
- If there were irreconcilable differences in negotiations that you were involved in, what would you do to help resolve them?

# Answer key

- 1.1**
- 1 I work *on*
  - 2 In fact, I *run*
  - 3 I *manage*
  - 4 One of my *main responsibilities*
  - 5 I'm also *in charge of*
  - 6 I deal *with*
  - 7 I'm *responsible for*
  - 8 I work closely *with*

- 1.2**
- 1 to      2 to      3 at      4 off
  - 5 in      6 out

- 1.3**
- 2 full-time work
  - 3 part-time work
  - 4 a temporary job
  - 5 permanent work
  - 6 a permanent job

## Over to you (sample answers)

If you work:

- I'm a pilot for a regional airline. I'm in charge of flying small planes (30 passengers) on short flights. My main responsibility is for the safety of the passengers, of course. My other responsibilities include leaving and arriving on time, and not using too much fuel.
- I usually leave home at 4.30 in the morning. The first flight is at 6 and I usually arrive at the airport at 5. I don't take a lot of time off work – I like flying too much!

If you don't work:

- I'd like to do something that involves working with other people.
- I'd like to work in a job with a regular routine, where I can leave home at 8 and know that I'll get back at 6. A nice comfortable office job would be nice!
- Some people prefer to work part-time because they have children to look after, or because they have other things that interest them. Some people like temporary jobs because they don't want to work for the same organization all the time. Other people like them because they want to take regular breaks so that they can travel, for example.

- 2.1** 1 b      2 d      3 a      4 f      5 c      6 e

- 2.2**
- 1 c working, boring, involves
  - 2 e being / to be
  - 3 a travelling, demanding, dealing

- 4 d tiring
- 5 b stimulating, repetitive

## Over to you (sample answers)

If you work:

- Yes, I have a nine-to-five job in a bank. I don't have to clock on and clock off. We have a swipe card we use when we enter the building. There is no flexitime system – we have to be there before the bank opens until after it closes. There are people who do shiftwork – taking calls from customers in our call centres.
- I deal with bank customers, so it would be difficult to do my job working from home!
- I like my colleagues, but I don't like some of our customers, who can be very rude!

If you don't work:

- I'd like to have regular hours. I wouldn't like any kind of shiftwork – it would be too stressful for me.
- I wouldn't like to work from home: I need to be with other people.
- I'd like a job that involves teamwork, working with figures, solving problems, working outdoors and helping other people.

- 3.1**
- |             |              |
|-------------|--------------|
| Across      | Down         |
| 5 recruited | 1 accepts    |
| 6 headhunt  | 2 turns down |
| 8 appoint   | 3 offers     |
|             | 4 hired      |
|             | 7 apply      |

- 3.2**
- 1 recruit, headhunt, appoint, offer, hire
  - 2 accept, turn down, apply

- 3.3**
- 1 turned down
  - 2 an interview
  - 3 his referees
  - 4 offered him
  - 5 accepted
  - 6 applications
  - 7 CVs
  - 8 applicants
  - 9 their qualifications
  - 10 shortlisted six people
  - 11 psychometric tests

## Over to you (sample answers)

If you work:

I work as a laboratory technician, and the recruitment process was quite long. I replied to



an advertisement on a jobs website – I sent them my CV with references and a covering letter. I was interviewed twice, first by the head of the laboratory and then by some of the people who worked with her. They checked my references, offered me the job, and I accepted it.

If you're a student:

Dear Sir/Madam

I saw the advertisement for gardeners on the Bristol City Council jobs website, and I would like to apply. I'm currently finishing a degree in garden design at University College Falmouth, and I would like to start a career in this area. I attach a CV, and I can provide references from my lecturers at University College.

I can travel at any time to Bristol for an interview.

Looking forward to hearing from you,

Yours sincerely,

- 4.1** 1 from, with, in 3 as  
2 in, as 4 on, in

- 4.2** 1 skilled 5 unskilled  
2 highly skilled 6 highly skilled  
3 semi-skilled 7 semi-skilled  
4 unskilled 8 skilled

- 4.3** 1 computer-literate, proactive, self-starter, team-player  
2 numerate  
3 motivated, driven  
4 self-starter, methodical, systematic, organized  
5 talented, motivated

#### Over to you (sample answer)

The job of sports shop manager requires someone who is good at sport, preferably good at three sports or more, so that they can advise customers on the right equipment to buy. Someone in this position has to be a self-starter, methodical and organized. You have to be computer-literate so that you can control stock and order new stock on time, and be good with people, as you will manage a staff of up to 15 people.

- 5.1** 1 salary  
2 overtime, commission  
3 bonus  
4 perks

- 5 company car  
6 pension  
7 benefits package

- 5.2** 1 compensation payment, severance payment  
2 compensation package, severance package  
3 performance-related bonus  
4 fat cats

#### Over to you (sample answers)

I'm a senior manager in a construction company. My basic salary is the most important thing. The benefits in order of importance are:

- 1 The performance-related bonuses that we get when we finish projects on time.
- 2 The share options that I get, based on the profits made by the company.
- 3 I hope to retire when I'm 55 or 60, and my pension is very important – so this is next.
- 4 And of course, the company car is a nice perk to have – I have a Jaguar.
- 5 The health plan that the company contributes to is another nice perk.

- 6.1** Across Down  
2 white 1 payroll  
5 staff 2 workforce  
6 manual 3 unions  
7 strike 4 blue  
9 employee 5 shopfloor  
10 outs 8 stoppage  
12 personnel 11 slow  
13 labour 14 go  
15 collar

- 6.2** 1 office  
2 head office  
3 headquarters  
4 open-plan  
5 administrative staff  
6 support  
7 human resources department  
8 HRD

#### Over to you (sample answers)

- Henkel has its head office in Dusseldorf, Germany. It has about 55,000 employees worldwide. It is a very large company with three main activities, and people work on different sites depending on the activity they work in. Some employees, for example administrative and support staff, work in open-plan offices.

- Personally, I would prefer to have my own office, rather than work in an open-plan office.

## 7.1

| Noun        | Verb      |
|-------------|-----------|
| retirement  | retire    |
| demotion    | demote    |
| lay-off     | layoff    |
| dismissal   | dismiss   |
| termination | terminate |

| Noun         | Adjective |
|--------------|-----------|
| seniority    | senior    |
| freelance(r) | freelance |
| redundancy   | redundant |
| insecurity   | insecure  |
| flexibility  | flexible  |

## 7.2

1 b    2 d    3 e    4 c    5 a

## 7.3

- reviews
- off
- contracts
- freelancers
- laying
- flatter
- leaner
- redundant
- outplacement

### Over to you (sample answers)

- Performance reviews are designed to help employees understand their weak and strong points, and to help them change the way that they work in order to improve their performance.
- An organization often restructures in order to become more efficient and profitable. Perhaps the structure that existed before is no longer suitable for new activities or objectives.
- The main advantage of outsourcing is that it allows an organization to concentrate on what it does best, rather than having to manage a range of activities that it does not do so well.
- People are dismissed for all sorts of reasons – perhaps because they have behaved in an unacceptable way, or because their performance is not as good as it should be and they have not reached their objectives.

## 8.1

- bullying
- sexual harassment, harassed
- glass ceiling, sex discrimination
- racial discrimination, racist, discriminated
- Affirmative action, affirmative action

## 8.2

- b
- a
- f
- e
- d
- c
- g

### Over to you (sample answer)

There are many health and safety hazards in the chemical industry. There are hazardous substances everywhere, and in some areas of the industry there is a risk of explosions. Activities have to be managed very carefully to avoid industrial accidents.

## 9.1

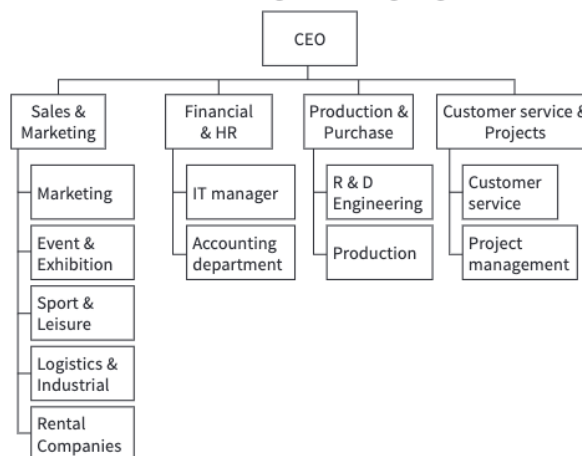
- marketing director
- research director
- finance director
- human resources director
- customer services manager
- sales manager

## 9.2

- President and CEO – Maria Montebello
- Non-executive director – George Gomi
- Non-executive director – Julia Jones
- CFO – Stan Smith
- VP Marketing – Clarissa Chang
- VP Research – Richard Roberts
- VP Personnel – Deirdre Dawes

### Over to you (sample answers)

#### Management Organigram



If you don't work:

I think I would be a very good lawyer. Even when I was at school, I was good at solving disagreements between people. I like speaking in public, and defending people who have been badly affected by the actions of others. I'd like to work in a law firm, working with other lawyers.

- 10.1** 1 entrepreneurs 5 grow  
2 entrepreneurial 6 leadership  
3 founded 7 empire  
4 start-up

- 10.2** Güler Sabancı: banking entrepreneur  
Cath Kidston: retail entrepreneur  
Jack Ma: e-commerce mogul  
Elon Musk: electric car entrepreneur  
Zhang Xin: property tycoon  
Mark Zuckerberg: social media website founder

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- In the UK, one famous entrepreneur is Richard Branson. He has founded all sorts of businesses. They form the Virgin group of companies. The group contains everything from a transatlantic airline to cable television services. Some of the companies are more successful than others. He likes to get into businesses that previously he knew nothing about. Branson is famous for his casual clothes, his long hair and his beard.
- Entrepreneurs are born, in my opinion. They seem to have unusual curiosity and enthusiasm. They are not easily discouraged when they don't succeed the first time. They are often good at knocking on doors and finding the right people to help them develop their ideas.

- 11.1** 1 d 2 c 3 a 4 f 5 b 6 e

- 11.2** 1 state-owned companies, government-owned companies, nationalized companies  
2 commercial airline  
3 bureaucracy  
4 commercial land  
5 commercial television  
6 enterprise  
7 commercial artist  
8 commercial disaster

- 11.3** 1 free enterprise  
2 private enterprise  
3 enterprise economy  
4 enterprise culture  
5 enterprise zone

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- In France, the public sector is very big. Public sector workers have good conditions: a short working week, and earlier retirement than in the private sector. But they are paid less than they would be in the private sector. However, public sector workers' conditions are slowly changing and becoming more like those in the private sector.
- Among the industries mentioned, electricity supply and rail transport are in the public sector. Telephone services have been privatized in the last few years.

- 12.1** 1 partnership  
2 plc  
3 corporation  
4 freelancer / sole trader / sole owner  
5 limited company

- 12.2** 1 demutualization 4 demutualized  
2 building society 5 demutualize  
3 members 6 mutual

- 12.3** 1 b 2 c 3 e 4 a 5 d

**Over to you (sample answer)**

In my country, a lot of charities work on social problems such as poverty or homelessness. Others work abroad to help people in poverty there, or to help them after natural disasters such as hurricanes. There are also charities which work on medical problems such as cancer.

- 13.1** 1 computer software 5 cars  
2 computer hardware 6 media  
3 pharmaceuticals 7 financial services  
4 aerospace 8 retail

- 13.2** 1 property 4 defence  
2 tourism 5 pharmaceuticals  
3 financial services

- 13.3** Across Down  
1 aerospace 1 automobile  
3 steel 2 defence  
4 service 5 catering  
6 manufacturing 7 health  
8 media 10 light  
9 industrial  
11 emerging  
12 growth  
13 pharmaceuticals

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- A wide range of goods is manufactured in my country, Turkey: everything from pharmaceuticals to trucks. There are a lot of plants in cities around Istanbul, and also in places such as Izmir and Bursa.
- The economy is quite diversified.

- 14.1** 2 observations            5 low response rates  
3 surveys                6 field trials  
4 moderator

- 14.2** a Market research  
b beta version  
c product launch  
d researchers  
e focus groups  
f safe  
g industrial scale  
h designers  
i testing/trialling  
j CAD/CAM

- 14.3** 1 market                5 launch  
2 groups                6 design  
3 consumer            7 recall  
4 surveys

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- Before it can release a new drug, a pharmaceutical company needs to do a lot of trials to make sure the drug is effective and safe. It then needs to get agreement from the authorities before the drug can be sold.
- I once took part in a survey where I had to taste a new brand of cola. The cola company who had organized the survey wanted to make sure that the taste of the new cola was more acceptable than the existing brands among young cola drinkers.
- If a company finds a problem in a product after the launch, they may have to recall the product in order to fix it. If this involves recalling tens of thousands of cars, for example, it can be very expensive, and some owners may not be aware of the recall.

- 15.1** 1 innovation            6 developed  
2 state-of-the-art      7 technology  
3 development        8 develop  
4 cutting edge        9 release  
5 technologies

- 15.2** 1 j            2 i            3 d            4 e            5 a  
6 b            7 h            8 g            9 c            10 f

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- Word processors like Amstrad and Wang became obsolete when personal computers appeared, and word processing – as well as many other things – could be done on a PC.
- Companies try to prevent illegal downloading by using technical devices such as copy protection, and by taking legal action against people who download material in large quantities, perhaps in order to sell it. Downloading is so common that companies will find it very difficult to stop it completely.

- 16.1** 1 manufacture / manufacturing / production, make(s) / manufacture(s) / produce(s), maker / manufacturer / producer  
2 provider, services  
3 producer, production  
4 provider  
5 producer, produced  
6 provision

- 16.2** 1 c            2 b            3 d            4 g            5 a  
6 f            7 e            8 h

- 16.3** 1 a            2 d            3 c            4 b

**Over to you (sample answer)**

It depends. Tailor-made – hand-made – clothes may fit better than mass-produced clothes, but entirely hand-made cars, put together without the help of computers and advanced machines, may not be such a good idea!

- 17.1** 1 capital                    6 parts  
2 knowledge              7 labour  
3 stocks / inventories 8 work-in-progress  
4 raw materials          9 stocks / inventories  
5 components            10 finished goods

- 17.2** 1 c            2 a            3 d            4 e            5 f            6 b

- 17.3** 1 just-in-time  
2 warehouses  
3 finance  
4 store  
5 efficient  
6 lean manufacturing/production



**Over to you (sample answers)**

- The advantage of outsourcing is that your company can concentrate on what it does best. But critics say that if you know enough about an activity to outsource it and to stay in control of it, then you might be able to do it just as well yourself.
- The advantage of asking for components 'just-in-time' is that the customer does not have to stock them and finance them before they are used. The disadvantage is that if they don't arrive on time, production has to stop.

- 18.1** 1 Wikinomics  
2 benchmarking  
3 the long tail  
4 mass customization

- 18.2** 1 e    2 a    3 d    4 b    5 f    6 c

- 18.3** 1 model                      4 long tail  
2 benchmarking          5 catalogue  
3 industrial secrets

**Over to you (sample answer)**

My organization is trying to improve efficiency by improving the flow of information between departments. It's difficult when people in one department don't know what those in another department are doing.

- 19.1** 1 b    2 c    3 f    4 e    5 d    6 a

- 19.2** 1 buyer, consumer, customer, purchaser  
2 customer base  
3 client  
4 client base, clientele  
5 seller  
6 seller, vendor  
7 buyer, purchaser  
8 street vendor  
9 buyer, purchaser, buying manager, purchasing manager  
10 user, end-user

- 19.3** 1 market-place  
2 market reforms  
3 Market prices  
4 market forces / market pressures  
5 market forces / market pressures  
6 market economy

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- In the UK, Marks and Spencer has a very large customer base, especially among the middle class.
- The purchasing manager in a large office is responsible for buying furniture, computer equipment and supplies, stationery, etc.

- 20.1** 1 penetrate                  4 monopolized  
2 cornered                  5 penetrate  
3 entering

- 20.2** 1 are the market leader  
2 have a 55 per cent market share  
3 Market growth is  
4 market segments  
5 market segmentation

- 20.3** 1 500                          4 A and B  
2 yes                          5 B, C, D and E  
3 A                              6 no

**Over to you (sample answer)**

In the UK mobile phone market, there are five competitors. Competition is very strong. The two market leaders are EE, with 32.9 per cent of the market, and O2, with 20.9 per cent. The other key players are Vodafone with 18.2 per cent and 3 Mobile with 10 per cent. The fifth, much smaller, competitor is Tesco Mobile, with 8.5 per cent.

- 21.1** 2 features                  7 the price  
3 benefits                  8 marketing mix  
4 the product              9 the packaging  
5 the promotion          10 marketers, marketeers  
6 the place

- 21.2** 1 f    2 d    3 a    4 e    5 g  
6 b    7 c

**Over to you (sample answer)**

Disney theme parks are famous for being market-oriented. They have the knowledge and understanding of customer needs that allow them to keep visitors happy: everything from supplying special raincoats when it rains, managing the queues for the different attractions, to serving the right food in the restaurants.

- 22.1** 1 placement                  4 lifecycle  
2 mix                          5 positioning  
3 lines                          6 portfolio

- 22.2** 1 consumer durables  
2 raw materials  
3 consumer durables  
4 fast-moving consumer goods  
5 fast-moving consumer goods

- 22.3** 1 c      2 a      3 g      4 h  
5 b      6 d      7 e      8 f

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- James Bond films provide possibilities for product placement for everything from cars to clothes to plasma TVs.
- The most famous brands of chocolate in the UK: Nestlé, Cadbury; soft drinks: Coca-Cola, Pepsi-Cola; breakfast cereal: Kellogg's; fast food: McDonald's, Kentucky Fried Chicken

- 23.1** 1 true                      4 true  
2 false                      5 false  
3 false                      6 true

- 23.2** 1 hike  
2 boom  
3 cuts  
4 controls

- 23.3** 1 It had an upmarket image.  
2 No, this added to its appeal.  
3 No, it also bought competitors, and launched products in addition to coffee.  
4 It has improved a lot.  
5 No, it's squeezed from below by fast food chains and from above by more sophisticated coffee shop chains.

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- In France, most people buy their cars through dealers. Other sources such as the internet are not much used.
- The lowest costs for home furniture are found at large specialized furniture shops on the edge of towns. As in many places, IKEA is increasing its number of shops.
- There are some supermarkets in town centres, but they do not usually have low prices. People go to out-of-town supermarkets like Casino and Intermarché, but there are even cheaper chains such as Lidl.
- The immediate advantage might be increased sales, but the long-term disadvantage might be damage to the company's brand image.

- 24.1** 1 distribution channel      4 resellers  
2 wholesalers              5 customer  
3 retailers                      6 retailers / resellers

- 24.2** 1 shopping mall              4 discounter  
2 shopping centre          5 department store  
3 convenience store        6 hypermarket

- 24.3** 1 junk mail                      4 cold calling  
2 call centre                   5 direct marketing  
3 mailshot                      6 telemarketing

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- City centre shops can be good: there are some good department stores where I live. But it can be difficult to park. With out-of-town shops, parking is free, but you have to drive there, and they can be a bit 'soulless' – without character.
- In the UK, wine companies often advertise by direct mail.
- As a consumer, telemarketing can be very annoying. The phone rings at inconvenient times, like mealtimes. I don't think I've ever bought anything following a telemarketing call.

- 25.1** Across                      Down  
4 promotions              1 hoarding  
6 displays                  2 loyalty  
7 samples                  3 commercials  
10 prizes                    5 territory  
11 agency                  7 sign  
14 force                    9 manager  
15 gifts                    12 medium  
16 advertisers            13 area  
17 women

- 25.2** 1 d      2 e      3 a      4 c      5 b

**Over to you (sample answers)**

- Manchester United are currently sponsored by Adidas, a German sportswear manufacturer, in a ten-year £750 million agreement.
- Many supermarket chains offer loyalty cards. Some coffee-shop chains do too: if you buy nine coffees, you get a tenth one free.

- 26.1** 1 B2C 3                      3 B2B                      5 B2C  
2 B2G 4                      4 B2G